HIGHER-DIMENSIONAL CROFTON FORMULA FOR RANDOM ZERO INTERSECTIONS AND HOLMES–THOMPSON VOLUME

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Editorial note. Only selected author result counted; complete original mathematical body and bibliography retained. Native vector figures and TikZ retained; source-class naming/counters mapped in the standalone rendering wrapper.

Editorial note. Explicit xcolor load supplies the native colored/masked random-arrow notation; original macro definition retained.

Editorial note. Explicit fancyvrb load retains the native appendix Verbatim block as text.

Editorial note. Root reused the unchanged complete author source/preamble/bibliography. One Crofton identity counted across dimensions; direct reciprocal-volume corollary uncounted.

Allowed standard prerequisites (editorial).

- Exterior algebra and basic Riemannian and Finsler geometry. All native zonoid, random-field, pullback and wedge constructions remain in the collected author text.. Only standard exterior-algebra and differential-geometric vocabulary is assumed; the stochastic-geometric core is included.

1. Introduction

1.1. **Overview.** Let $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^k$ be a random smooth function on a smooth Riemannian manifold M of dimension m. Under the hypothesis that the random subset $Z := X^{-1}(0)$ is almost surely a submanifold, we study the following functionals:

$$A \mapsto \mathbb{E}\left\{\mathrm{vol}_{(m-k)}(Z \cap A)\right\}, \qquad \omega \mapsto \mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega\right\}, \tag{1}$$

where $A \subset M$ is any Borel subset and ω is any smooth differential $(m-k)$-form with compact support, that is, $\omega \in \Omega_c^{m-k}(M)$. In more fancy words, the former is the measure obtained by taking the expectation of the random measure "$(m-k)$-volume of the intersection with Z"; while the latter, which is defined whenever Z is oriented, is the current obtained by taking the expectation of the random current $\int_Z \in \Omega_c^{m-k}(M)^*$. Our aim is not just to find formulas for them two, but to establish a framework to understand the relations among them for multiple instances of Z.

1.1.1. *The examples that we have in mind.* There is a vast literature dedicated to the study of nodal sets of random fields [4, 6, 17, 48]. The first example in our mind is Kostlan polynomials [37], studied in relation with real algebraic geometry [70, 71, 72], [29, 30, 31], [60, 61], [14, 16, 27, 36, 41, 42, 44]; then, random submanifolds in homogenous spaces and integral geometry [11, 15, 43]; random eigenfunctions and Riemannian random waves [9, 83], a topic that in the current years is at the center of a lot of attention, see [21, 22, 23, 28, 35, 39, 46, 49, 51, 50, 53, 54, 55, 59, 65, 75, 80] and the surveys [20, 47, 81, 82]. The vast majority of these works deals with Gaussian random fields [17, 45, 56, 61, 62, 58]. The methods and the results proposed in this paper are aimed to a general study of random fields including non-Gaussian situations, see for instance [38, 73].

Our results are also to be compared with the work of Akhiezer and Kazarnovskii [1]. Their *average number of zeros*, corresponds, in our case, to the average number of zeroes of a system of independent scalar Gaussian random fields in finite dimensional function spaces. In [34], a more general distribution than Gaussian is covered although it remains in the setting of scalar fields in finite dimensional function spaces. It is yet unclear for us if Kazarnovskii's "B-bodies" correspond to our zonoid section.

1.2. **Main results.**

Date: doi:10.5802/ahl.214; CC BY 4.0.

1.2.1. *Expected length and currents.* We propose to study the functionals in (1) using zonoids - a special family of convex bodies (see § 3). A convex body is a zonoid if it can be approximated, in the Hausdorff topology, by a finite Minkowski sums of segments. To any regular enough random function $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^k$ we associate a field of convex bodies in the exterior algebra of the cotangent space:

$$M \ni p \mapsto \zeta_X(p) \subset \Lambda^k T_p^* M.$$

For any $p \in M$, the convex body $\zeta_X(p)$ is a zonoid defined as the expectation of a random segment, via the following formula (Theorem 5.1):

$$\zeta_X(p) := \mathbb{E}\left\{ \left[0, \mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right] \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0), \tag{2}$$

where $\rho_{X(p)} : \mathbb{R}^k \to [0, +\infty]$ is the density of the random vector $X(p)$. Every convex body K has a well defined *length* $\ell(K)$, that is, the first intrinsic volume (Theorem 3.9) of K, also called the first Lipschitz–Killing curvature [4]. Moreover, a zonoid K always has a center of symmetry $c(K)$. For technical reasons we will have to consider the point $e(K) := 2c(K)$, which we named *nigiro*, see Theorem 3.3. Finally, we identify a set of desired condition on the random field X under which we can apply a Kac–Rice formula. We call those the *z-KROK* conditions, see below after Theorem A. The first main result of the paper is the following theorem.

Theorem A. Let $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^k$ be a *z-KROK* random field and let $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Then there is a continuous section of zonoids ζ_X as in (2) such that:

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\mathrm{vol}_{(m-k)}(Z \cap A)\right\} = \int_A \delta_Z dM, \qquad \mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega\right\} = \int_M e_Z \wedge \omega, \tag{3}$$

where $\delta_Z(p) = \ell(\zeta_X(p)) \in \mathbb{R}$ and $e_Z(p) = e(\zeta_X(p)) \in \Lambda^k T_p^* M$ are a continuous function and a continuous k-form, respectively, and where $\int_A f dM$ denotes the integral of a function f on the subset $A \subset M$, with respect to the Riemannian volume measure of M. We call ζ_X the *zonoid section* of X.

In the main body of the paper, Theorem A is divided into Theorem 7.1 and Theorem 7.7.

The description of the *z-KROK* hypotheses (Theorem 4.1) is an important part of this work (see § 4) in that they are the conditions that are required to employ our version of the Kac–Rice formula (Theorem 6.2), on which Theorem A is ultimately based. Roughly speaking, a random field $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^k$ is *z-KROK* if (Compare with [74, 2.1]):

(1) X is almost surely of class $\mathcal{C}^1$.
(2) 0 is a regular value of X, almost surely. This is to guarantee that $Z = X^{-1}(0)$ is almost surely a submanifold.
(3) The law of $X(p)$ on $\mathbb{R}^k$ is absolutely continuous and …
(4) …its density $\rho_{X(p)}(x)$ is continuous in both variables at $(p, 0)$.
(5) The conditional expectation $\mathbb{E}\{J_p X | X(p) = 0\}$ makes sense and it is regular enough, where for every $f = (f^1, \ldots, f^k) \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, we write $J_p f := \|d_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p f^k\|$.

If X is Gaussian, then it is very easy to check the *z-KROK* conditions (see Theorem 4.9 and Theorem 4.10) and in this case the zonoids $\zeta_X(p)$ are ellipsoids.

We can express the length and the nigiro of the zonoid section as follows.

$$\begin{aligned} \ell(\zeta_X(p)) &= \mathbb{E}\left\{J_p X \,|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0), \\ e(\zeta_X(p)) &= \mathbb{E}\left\{d_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p X^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0), \end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

where $X = (X^1, \ldots, X^k)$ and $J_p X$ denotes the Jacobian determinant of X, that is, $J_p X = \|d_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p X^k\|$. From the first equation in (4), the reader that is familiar with Kac–Rice formulas, can recognize that the first identity in (3) is in fact a translation of the most common version of it (see [6]). On the contrary, the formula obtained by combining the second identities in (3) and (4) is new.

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega\right\} = \int_M \left(\mathbb{E}\left\{d_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p X^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0)\right) \wedge \omega, \tag{5}$$

Although it is based on Kac–Rice formula, to the authors' knowledge such a general result for the expected current was not available in the literature. In particular, under our hypotheses, the resulting current is represented by a continuous differential form. Other works which study the expected current of a random submanifold are [3, 24, 25, 40, 56, 62, 76, 77].

Remark 1.1. If $X(p)$ and $d_p X$ are stochastically independent, then the conditioning disappears:

$$\zeta_X(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{\left[0, \mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right]\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0),$$

see Theorem 4.4.

1.2.2. *The wedge and pull-back properties.* Given two independent random fields X_1, X_2, with zero sets $Z_i := X_i^{-1}(0)$, $i = 1, 2$, one can study the intersection $Z_0 := Z_1 \cap Z_2$ as the zero set of the random field $X_0 := (X_1, X_2)$. The idea behind this paper is to answer to the following questions:

Question 1.2. Suppose that you are given X_1 and you know that *tomorrow* you will have to compute $\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}$ or $e_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}$ for some yet unknown X_2. What can you do *today* to start simplifying *tomorrow*'s work?

In more formal terms, we want to identify some objects associated to X_1 and X_2 that are sufficient to determine the density $\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}$ and the form $e_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}$ and a set of rules to compute them.

In the case of the expected current the answer is pretty simple since, by linearity, we have $e_{Z_1 \cap Z_2} = e_{Z_1} \wedge e_{Z_2}$, so the answer to Theorem 1.2 is that one needs to compute the form e_{Z_1} in this case.

In the volume case things are more subtle in that the couple $(\delta_{Z_1}, \delta_{Z_2})$ is not a sufficient data to determine $\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}$. This is where the zonoid section really comes into play as an elegant answer to Theorem 1.2.

For example, if $S \subset M$ is a submanifold and the field $Y = X|_S$ is *z-KROK*, then $e_Y = e_X|_S$, but the density of expected volume δ_Y is not determined by δ_X. However, the zonoid section of Y is determined by that of X, via pull-back.

Theorem B (Pull-back property)**.** Let $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^k$ be *z-KROK*. Let S be a smooth manifold and let $\varphi\colon S \to M$ be a smooth map such that $\varphi \pitchfork X^{-1}(0)$ almost surely. Then $X \circ \varphi\colon S \to \mathbb{R}^k$ is *z-KROK* and

$$\zeta_{X\circ\varphi}(q) = d_q\varphi^* \left(\zeta_X\left(\varphi(q)\right)\right), \quad \forall\, q \in S. \tag{6}$$

Recently in [7] a framework was developed by the first author together with Breiding, Bürgisser and Lerario to build multilinear maps on zonoids from multilinear maps on the underlying vector spaces, see Theorem 3.13 or [7, Theorem 4.1] In particular, the *wedge product* of two zonoids $\zeta_1 \subset \Lambda^{k_1} T_p^* M$ and $\zeta_2 \subset \Lambda^{k_2} T_p^* M$ is defined and lives in $\Lambda^{k_1+k_2} T_p^* M$.

Theorem C (Wedge property)**.** Let $X_i\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^{k_i}$ be independent *z-KROK* random fields. Let $X_0 := (X_1, X_2)\colon M \to \mathbb{R}^{k_1+k_2}$ and assume that $X_0 \pitchfork 0$ almost surely. Then, X_0 is *z-KROK* and

$$\zeta_{X_0} = \zeta_{X_1} \wedge \zeta_{X_2}.$$

In other words, an answer to (1.2) above is to compute the zonoid section of X_1, so that *tomorrow* it will be sufficient to apply Theorem A and Theorem C to get $\delta_{Z_1\cap Z_2} = \ell(\zeta_{X_1} \wedge \zeta_{X_2})$. The passage from X, a probability law on $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, to ζ_X is a big reduction of data since the zonoid $\zeta_X(p)$ is defined pointwise (Theorem 5.1) and depends only on the law of

$$\left(X(p), d_pX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_pX^k\right) \text{ random vector in } \mathbb{R}^k \times \Lambda^k T_p^* M,$$

hence the zonoid section does not remember the whole correlation structure of the field X. This is the same spirit as that of Kac–Rice formula.

Remark 1.3. It is important that the *z-KROK* hypotheses are stable enough to allow the operations in both Theorem C and Theorem B, while keeping Theorem A true. The transversality hypothesis in Theorem B and in Theorem C cannot be avoided, as shown in Theorem 10.6. Nevertheless, in many cases it is automatically satisfied, for instance when the fields are Gaussian and smooth (see Theorem 4.10), or when the fields are of the form $X = Y - \lambda$ discussed in § 1.3.6, see Theorem 10.4.

1.2.3. *Alexandrov–Fenchel and Brunn–Minkowski.* The results just discussed create a bridge between random fields and the very rich theory of convex bodies. Such connection allows to draw on deep results such as the Alexandrov–Fenchel inequality (Theorem 3.19 and [68, Theorem 7.3.1]) and the Brunn–Minkowski inequality (Theorem 3.20 and [68, p. 372 (e)]) to obtain relations between different instances of δ_Z. The former allows to deduce Theorem D which, in the case M is a surface, says the following. Let us say that a *z-KROK* field X is *self-transverse* if given X' an independent copy of it, we have that $(X, X') \pitchfork (0, 0)$ almost surely.

Theorem D (KRAF for surfaces)**.** Let $\dim M = 2$ and let Z_1, Z_2 be random curves defined by independent self-transverse *z-KROK* fields, then, for all $p \in M$,

$$\delta_{Z_1\cap Z_2}(p) \geq \sqrt{\delta_{Z_1\cap Z_1'}(p) \cdot \delta_{Z_2\cap Z_2'}(p)}, \tag{7}$$

where Z_i' is an independent copy of Z_i.

Similarly, from the Brunn–Minkowski inequality we deduce Theorem E.

Theorem E (KRBM for surfaces)**.** Let $\dim M = 2$ and let Z_1, Z_2 be random curves defined by independent self-transverse *z-KROK* fields. For $t \in [0, 1]$, let Z_t be the random curve such that $Z_t = Z_2$ with probability t and $Z_t = Z_1$ otherwise. Then, for all $p \in M$,

$$\delta_{Z_t\cap Z_t'}(p) \geq \delta^{(1-t)}_{Z_1\cap Z_1'}(p)\delta^t_{Z_2\cap Z_2'}(p) \tag{8}$$

where Z_i' is an independent copy of Z_i.

This result is based on the observation that Z_t is the zero set of another field X_t that, if *z-KROK*, has for zonoid section the *Minkowski sum* of the other two: $\zeta_{X_t} = (1-t)\zeta_{X_1} + t\zeta_{X_2}$, see Theorem 5.3.

Remark 1.4. The inequality (8) actually involves the same three terms as (7). Indeed from the definition of Z_t it is immediate to deduce that:

$$\delta_{Z_t \cap Z_t'} = (1-t)^2 \delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_1'} + t^2 \delta_{Z_2 \cap Z_2'} + 2t(1-t)\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_2}.$$

In the full statements of Theorem D and Theorem E (see Subsection 7.2) there is no assumption on the dimension of M and the notion of self-transverse is replaced by *multi-transverse* (Theorem 7.2).

1.2.4. *Comment on the proof of Theorem A.* The main technical result that we need and that is the content of Theorem 6.2 is the following version of Kac–Rice formula expressing the expectation of the integral of some functional $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ over the submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0)$ defined by a random field $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$:

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \alpha(X,p)dZ(p)\right\} = \int_M \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X,p)J_pX \mid X(p)=0\right\}\rho_{X(p)}(0)dM(p), \tag{9}$$

where again $\int_Z \alpha dZ$ denotes the integral with respect to the Riemannian volume measure of Z, considered with the Riemannian metric induced by $Z \subset M$. We don't consider this an original result, since this formula is essentially known as one of the many variations of Kac–Rice. Nevertheless, we remark that we couldn't find any reference in the literature for a statement equivalent to Theorem 6.2, which is crucial for us since it shows the validity of (9) under the hypothesis that X is a *z-KROK* random field, except for the case when $k = \dim M$, that is Theorem 6.1 and for which we refer to [74] (see also Section A).

We also remark that to obtain Theorem 6.2 we use an argument that is new in this context and which shows that the validity of Formula (9) just in the case $k = \dim M$, when Z is discrete, implies its validity for all cases. For this we exploit the properties of a class of Gaussian random fields on a Riemannian manifold (M,g), that we call *normal*, defined as those for which g is the associated metric in the sense of [4], see Subsection 6.1. This strategy reflects the philosophy of this paper in that it exploits the interplay between different instances of the Kac–Rice formula.

1.3. **Other results.**

1.3.1. *Density of intersection in terms of mixed volumes.* To a convex body $K \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, one can associate $d+1$ numbers $\mathcal{V}_0(K), \ldots, \mathcal{V}_d(K)$ called the *intrinsic volumes* of K (also called *Lipschitz–Killing curvatures* in more general contexts [4]). They are the coefficients in Steiner's formula [68]: $\mathrm{vol}_d(K + tB_d) = \sum_{i=0}^d \mathcal{V}_{d-i}(K)\,\mathrm{vol}_i(tB_i)$, where $B_i \subset \mathbb{R}^i$ is the unit ball. The *length* $\mathcal{V}_1(K) = \ell(K)$ is the one appearing in Theorem A. Then, the Euler characteristic $\mathcal{V}_0(K) = \chi(K) \in \{0,1\}$ only tells if K is empty or not and $\mathcal{V}_d(K) = \mathrm{vol}_d(K)$ is the usual volume.

The role of the intrinsic volumes in our picture is clarified by the wedge product of zonoids [7]. In particular, if $K = \zeta$ is a zonoid, we have $i!\mathcal{V}_i(\zeta) = \ell(\zeta^{\wedge i})$, see Theorem 3.17. Combining it with Theorem A and Theorem C, this yields Theorem 7.3:

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\mathrm{vol}_d(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_k)\right\} = k! \int_M \mathcal{V}_k(\zeta_X)dM,$$

whenever Z_i are i.i.d. zero sets of a scalar *z-KROK* random field $X\colon M \to \mathbb{R}$. The notion of intrinsic volume for zonoids is related to that of *mixed volume*. The mixed volume of m convex bodies $K_1, \ldots, K_m \subset \mathbb{R}^m$, denoted $\mathrm{MV}(K_1, \ldots, K_m)$, is defined as the coefficient of $t_1 \cdots t_m$ in the polynomial $\mathrm{vol}_d(t_1K_1 + \ldots t_mK_m)$, see [68, Theorem 5.1.7]. If $Z_1, \ldots, Z_m$ are random level sets of m independent scalar *z-KROK* field $X_1, \ldots, X_m$ respectively, on a m dimensional manifold M, then, provided that Z_i are almost surely transverse to each other, Theorem 7.3 states also that

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\#(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_m)\right\} = m! \int_M \mathrm{MV}(\zeta_{X_1}, \ldots, \zeta_{X_m})dM.$$

1.3.2. *What does the zonoid section know?* The zonoid section can be separated into two parts as follows, see Theorem 3.3.

$$\zeta_X(p) = \frac{1}{2}e(\zeta_X(p)) + \underline{\zeta_X(p)} \tag{10}$$

where $\underline{\zeta_X(p)}$ has its center of symmetry at the origin. The length, and thus the density of expected volume, depends only the centered zonoid, that is, on $\underline{\zeta_X(p)}$. In general, the centered zonoid is a sufficient data

to compute the expectation of all quantities of the form $\int_Z F(T_pZ)dZ$. More precisely, given a measurable function $F : G(m-k, TM) \to \mathbb{R}$, we have

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z F\left(T_pZ\right) dZ(p)\right\} = \int_{G(m-k,TM)} F\, dV_{\underline{\zeta_X}}, \tag{11}$$

where $V_{\underline{\zeta_X}}$ is a measure on $G(m-k, TM)$ associated to the centered zonoid section $\underline{\zeta_X}$ via the *cosine transform*, see § 3.3. The function $\underline{\zeta_X} \mapsto V_{\underline{\zeta_X}}$ is, in fact, injective

We will discuss this in more details in § 7.4. In particular, we will show that the centered zonoid section $\underline{\zeta_X}$ depends only on the law of the random submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0)$, see Theorem 7.14.

1.3.3. *The zonoid section as the expectation of a random varifold.* A d-Varifold in M is a positive Borel measure on the total space of the Grassmann bundle

$$G(d, TM) = \{V \subset T_pM : p \in M, V \text{ is a linear subspace of dimension } d\}.$$

We thus can think of a d-varifold V as a linear continuous functional $F \mapsto V(F)$, defined for every bounded continuous function $F : G(d, TM) \to \mathbb{R}$ and such that $V(F) \leq C \sup |F|$ for some constant $C \in [0, +\infty)$. Traditionally, varifold are introduced as a non-oriented variant of the concept of currents. Indeed, any non-necessarily-oriented d dimensional compact submanifold $Z \subset M$ of a Riemannian manifold M canonically defines a varifold $V_Z(F) := \int_M F(T_pZ)dM(p)$.

On the other hand, a classical result in the theory of zonoids (see [68]) is that centered zonoids in a Euclidean space V are in $1-1$ correspondence with even measures on the sphere $S(V)$. In our case, the zonoid $\zeta_X(p)$ of a *z-KROK* field $X : M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$, lives in $V = \Lambda^k T_p^*M$ and it is special in that the associated measure is supported on the space of simple vectors, which can be identified with $G(k, T_p^*M) \cong G(d, T_pM)$, where we set $d = m-k$. Because of this observation, a zonoid section $\zeta = \{\zeta(p)\}_{p \in M}$, is uniquely associated to a section of measures $\{\mu_{\zeta(p)}\}_{p \in M}$ and we can use this data to construct a d-varifold V_ζ via the formula (see (58)).

$$V_\zeta(F) = \int_M \int_{G(d,T_pM)} F(V) d\mu_{\zeta(p)}(V) dM(p).$$

We have the following.

Theorem F (Expectation of a random varifold)**.** Let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be a *z-KROK* random field, and let $d = m-k$ be the dimension of the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Then

$$\mathbb{E}V_Z = V_{\zeta_X}.$$

We will prove that (see Theorem 7.12), in the case in which $\zeta = \zeta_X$ is the zonoid section of a *z-KROK* field, one can recover the zonoid section ζ_X from the varifold V_{ζ_X} and viceversa. In this sense, Theorem F explains the title of the paper.

1.3.4. *Many representatives of the Euler class.* All the previous results extend naturally to random sections of vector bundles (Theorem 8.6); if $\pi\colon E \to M$ is a smooth vector bundle of rank k and $X\colon M \to E$ is a random section that is *z-KROK* in any local trivialization (in this case we say that it is *locally z-KROK*, see Theorem 8.1) then the zonoid section is defined (Theorem 8.5) as a function of the form:

$$M \ni p \mapsto \zeta_X(p) \subset \Lambda^k T_p^*M \otimes \det E_p,$$

where we recall that $\det E := \Lambda^k E$ is a real line bundle, trivial if and only if E is orientable. The reader who is familiar with algebraic topology will recognize a strong analogy between such extensions of Theorem C and Theorem B with the axiomatic properties of characteristic classes of vector bundles. Indeed, in the case in which both M and E are orientable the expected current $e(\zeta_X) = \mathbb{E}\int_Z$, if smooth, is in fact a closed k-form representing the De Rham–Euler class of E:

$$[e(\zeta_X)] = e(E) \in H^k_{DR}(M), \tag{12}$$

see Theorem 8.6(4). A more subtle version of this fact holds without any orientability assumption, see Theorem 8.8 and Theorem 8.9. (12) can be regarded as a generalized Gauss–Bonnet–Chern theorem (see [57, 69]) in that on the left there is a *local* object that depends on the structure of the random field, while on the right hand side we have a *global* topological quantity depending only on the bundle. In other words, a random section specifies a way to distribute the Euler class of E over the manifold M. For instance in the case when $k = m$ the Euler class becomes a number: the Euler characteristic $\chi(E) \in \mathbb{Z}$ and (12) reads

$$\int_M e(\zeta_X) = \chi(E). \tag{13}$$

The classical statement of Gauss–Bonnet–Chern Theorem for a vector bundle E endowed with a metric h and a connection ∇ can be recovered from (12) by taking X to be a suitable Gaussian random section. This has been proved, by direct computations, in [56].

1.3.5. *Finsler Crofton formula.* In § 9 we give an interpretation of our results in the context of *Finsler Geometry* [8]. Given a scalar *z-KROK* random field $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M)$ on M, the convex body $\zeta(p) := \overline{\zeta_X(p)}$, if full dimensional, defines a norm $F_p := h_{\zeta(p)} : T_pM \to \mathbb{R}$, that is continuous with respect to $p \in M$. This norm is such that the convex body $\zeta(p)$ is the dual of the unit ball, see Theorem 9.3. Such an assignment is called a *Finsler structure*[1]. In our case the convex body $\zeta(p)$ always contains the origin and depends continuously on p but may not be full dimensional, thus $h_{\zeta(p)}$ only defines a *semi* norm. We will call a *semi Finsler* structure the choice of a semi norm $F_p : T_pM \to \mathbb{R}$ that depends continuously on $p \in M$. Then we have that a scalar *z-KROK* random field $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ defines a semi Finsler structure F^X, see Theorem 9.3.

Given a (semi) Finsler structure F on M, the usual definition of the length of a curve as the integral of the norm of the velocity still makes sense, see (66). Combining the pull-back property (Theorem B) with Theorem A we are able to produce a Crofton formula, that is, to relate the length of a curve with the expectation of the number of points of intersection with an hypersurface. More precisely, if $X : M \to \mathbb{R}$ is *z-KROK*, $Z = X^{-1}(0)$ and γ is a C^1 curve in M almost surely transversal to Z, then we have, see Theorem 9.4:

$$\mathbb{E}\#(\gamma \cap Z) = 2\,\ell^{F^X}(\gamma).$$

Unlike for the length, there are several notions of the volume of a k dimensional submanifold $S \subset M$ in Finsler geometry, see [85]. One of the most common is the *Holmes–Thompson volume*, which is still defined in the semi Finsler case and we denote it as $\mathrm{vol}_k^F(S)$. It turns out that in the case in which the semi Finsler structure F^X is defined by a scalar self-transverse *z-KROK* field X we can also prove a Crofton formula for the Holmes-Thompson volume (Theorem 9.9):

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\#(S \cap Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_k)\right\} = k! b_k \,\mathrm{vol}_k^{F^X}(S),$$

where Z_i are independent copies of $Z = X^{-1}(0)$ and $S \subset M$ is any k dimensional submanifold almost surely transversal to Z. Constructions of Finsler structures that admit a Crofton formula are known for random hyperplanes in projective space, see [10, 64, 67]. Moreover, a more general result very similar to Theorem 9.4 can be found in [84, Theorem A] although the *z-KROK* hypotheses are significantly less restrictive and the construction of the metric F^X is explicit (see (67)).

1.3.6. *Examples.* With Theorem 10.1 we show that any random field $Y \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ can be *approximated* by a *z-KROK* random field, with the only condition being that $\mathbb{E}\{J_pY\}$ should be finite and continuous with respect to $p \in M$. Such operation is obtained by means of what can be described as a convolution with a constant field, that is, a random vector $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^k$, provided that the latter has a continuous, bounded and non vanishing density. In this case,

$$X := Y - \lambda \text{ is } z\text{-}KROK. \tag{14}$$

This result, while demonstrating the abundance of *z-KROK* fields, suggests that they could be used to study more wild random fields via perturbative techniques. The study of the behavior of the results obtained in this paper when $\lambda \to 0$ in (14) will be object of future work by the authors.

A particular case of (14) is when $Y = f$ is a deterministic smooth function, so that $Z = Y^{-1}(\lambda)$ is a random level set of f. We discuss this example in § 10.1.

In § 10.3 we discuss the case when the law of the random field X is supported on a finite dimensional linear subspace $\mathcal{F} \subset \mathcal{C}^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and has a density $\rho_X \colon \mathcal{F} \to [0, +\infty)$. This is the most typical situation in the existing literature (see § 1.1.1). It includes especially the case of random eigenfunctions of elliptic operators, Riemannian random waves and random band limited functions, not necessarily Gaussian. It also naturally applies to random polynomials.

We show (see Theorem 10.7 and Theorem 10.8) that such X is always *z-KROK* as long as $\mathcal{F}$ is ample, meaning that for any $p \in M$ the set $\{f(p) \colon f \in \mathcal{F}\}$ spans the whole $\mathbb{R}^k$ (i.e., $\mathcal{F}$ generates $\mathcal{C}^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ as a $\mathcal{C}^\infty(M)$-module), and if the density satisfies the integrability condition $\rho_X(f) = O(\|f\|^{-\dim \mathcal{F}})$ as $\varphi \to \infty$.

[1] In general the norm of a Finsler structure is also assumed to have some C^2 regularity that we won't assume here.

1.4. **Structure of the paper.** § 3 contains a brief survey on the theory of convex bodies and zonoids, with emphasis on the formulas and the notations that are needed in the following sections. This section is essentially based on the monograph [68] and on the recent paper [7]. In § 4 we define the *z-KROK* hypotheses in details, discussing alternative formulations and special cases. We give the definition of the zonoid section in § 5 and the proof of Theorem C and Theorem B. In § 6.2 we establish the Kac–Rice formula (Theorem 6.2) that we need to prove Theorem A. The latter is divided into two statements, Theorem 7.1 and Theorem 7.7, both proved in § 7. In § 7.2 we report the full statements of Theorem D and Theorem E, which are obtained as corollaries of Theorem 7.1. The subsequent sections cover the material discussed in § 1.3 above, in particular, the proof of Theorem F is given in § 7.4.

1.5. **Acknowledgements.** The authors would like to thank YOU.

2. Notations

Here below, a list of the main notations used in this paper, for the reader's convenience.

- We say that X is a *random element* (see [13]) of the topological space T if X is a measurable map $X\colon \Omega \to T$, defined on some probability space $(\Omega, \mathfrak{S}, \mathbb{P})$. In this case we will write
$$X \in T$$
and we denote by $[X] = \mathbb{P}X^{-1}$ the Borel probability measure on T induced by pushforward. We will use the following notation:
$$\mathbb{P}\{X \in U\} := \mathbb{P}X^{-1}(U)$$
to denote the probability that $X \in U$, for some measurable subset $U \subset T$, and
$$\mathbb{E}\{f(X)\} := \int_T f(t)d[X](t),$$
to denote the integral of a measurable function $f\colon T \to \mathbb{R}$. Here, the integral is meant in the usual sense of measure theory, for which we refer to [12, section 15], and takes value in $\mathbb{R}\cup\{+\infty, -\infty, \infty - \infty\}$.
  We call X a *random variable*, *random vector* or *random map* if T is the real line, a vector space or a space of continuous functions $\mathcal{C}(M, N)$, respectively.
- Given topological spaces M and N, we write
$$X\colon M \multimap N,$$
to say that X is a random map, i.e., a random element of $\mathcal{C}(M, N)$. The symbol winks at the fact that X can be seen as a function $X\colon M \times \Omega \to N$.
- The sentence: "X has the property $\mathcal{P}$ almost surely" (abbreviated "a.s.") means that the set $S = \{t \in T | t \text{ has the property } \mathcal{P}\}$ contains a Borel set of $[X]$-measure 1. It follows, in particular, that the set S is $[X]$-measurable, i.e. it belongs to the σ-algebra obtained from the completion of the measure space $(T, \mathcal{B}(T), [X])$.
- We write $\#(S)$ for the cardinality of the set S.
- We use the symbol $A \pitchfork B$ to say that objects A and B are in transverse position, in the usual sense of differential topology (as in [33]).
- The space of $\mathcal{C}^r$ functions between two manifolds M and N is denoted by $\mathcal{C}^r(M, N)$. We just write $\mathcal{C}^r(M)$ in the case $N = \mathbb{R}$. If $E \to M$ is a vector bundle, we denote the space of its $\mathcal{C}^r$ sections by $\mathcal{C}^r(M|E)$. In both cases, we consider it to be a topological space endowed with the weak Whitney's topology (see [33]).
- We use $\Gamma(\mathcal{Z})$ for the space of continuous sections of a continuous fiber bundle $\mathcal{Z} \to M$.
- Given a topological space T, we denote by $\mathcal{M}(T)$ the topological vector space of finite signed Borel measures, endowed with the weak-$*$ topology induced by the inclusion $\mathcal{M}(T) \subset \mathcal{C}_b(T)^*$. We write $\mathcal{M}^+(T)$ for the subset of positive finite measures and $\mathscr{P}(T)$ for that of probability measures, both considered with the subspace topology, if not otherwise specified.
- If V is a vector space and $x, y \in V$, we write $[x, y] := \{(1-t)x + ty \,|\, t \in [0, 1]\}$. Moreover, we abbreviate
$$\underline{x} := \frac{1}{2}[-x, x]. \tag{15}$$
- We use b_k for the k dimensional volume of the unit ball in $\mathbb{R}^k$ and $s_k = \frac{2^{k+1}\pi^k}{k!b_k}$ for the k dimensional volume of the unit sphere in $\mathbb{R}^{k+1}$.

3. Zonoids

Throughout this section $(V, \langle\cdot,\cdot\rangle)$ is a (real) Euclidean space of dimension m, V^* its dual and $S(V)$ is the unit sphere of V.

3.1. **Basic definitions.** A subset K of V is *convex* if for every $x, y \in K$, the segment $[x, y] = \{(1-t)x+ty | t \in [0, 1]\}$ is contained in K. A *convex body* is a non empty compact convex subset. If $K \subset V$ is a convex body, its *support function* is the positively homogeneous function $h_K : V^* \to \mathbb{R}$ given by

$$h_K(u) := \sup\{\langle u, x\rangle \,|\, x \in K\}.$$

The support function determines the convex body K, meaning that two convex bodies K and K' are equal if and only if $h_K = h_{K'}$, see [68, Section 1.7.1]. Moreover, a function $h : V^* \to \mathbb{R}$ is the support function of a convex body in V if and only if it is *sublinear*, that is if $h(\lambda u) = \lambda h(u)$ for all $u \in V^*, \lambda \geq 0$ and $h(u + v) \leq h(u) + h(v)$ for all $u, v \in V^*$; see [68, Theorem 1.7.1].

The norm on V^* induces a complete distance on the space of convex bodies of V called the *Hausdorff distance* [32]. This is equivalent to the supremum distance of the support functions, given for all $K_1, K_2 \subset V$ convex bodies by (see[68, Lemma 1.8.14]):

$$\mathrm{d}(K_1, K_2) = \sup\{|h_{K_1}(u) - h_{K_2}(u)| \,|\, \|u\| = 1\}. \tag{16}$$

The *Minkowski sum* of two convex bodies $K_1, K_2 \subset V$ is the convex body defined as:

$$K_1 + K_2 := \{x_1 + x_2 \,|\, x_1 \in K_1,\, x_2 \in K_2\}.$$

Finally we define for every $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ and convex body K, the convex body $\lambda K := \{\lambda x \,|\, x \in K\}$.

The support function satisfy some useful properties that we summarize in the next proposition. Those are direct consequences of the definition and for this reason we omit the proof.

Proposition 3.1. *Let K, L be convex bodies in a vector space V and let h_K, respectively h_L be their support functions. We have the following.*

1. *For all $t, s \geq 0$ we have $h_{tK+sL} = th_K + sh_L$.*
2. *If W is a vector space and $T : V \to W$ is a linear map then $h_{T(K)} = h_K \circ T^t$ where $T^t : W^* \to V^*$ is the transpose (or adjoint) of the map T.*

We are interested in a particular class of convex bodies.

Definition 3.2. A *zonotope* is a finite Minkowski sum of segments. A *zonoid* is a limit, in the Hausdorff distance, of zonotopes.

Segments are always centrally symmetric and we can write $[x, y] = \underline{x - y} + \frac{1}{2}\{x + y\}$ where we recall the notation defined in (15). It follows that zonotopes, and thus zonoids are centrally symmetric. Moreover K is a zonotope if and only if there exist $x_1, \ldots, x_N, e \in V$ such that $K = \underline{x_1} + \cdots + \underline{x_N} + \frac{1}{2}\{e\}$. This implies that for every zonoid K there is a zonoid $\underline{K}$ with $(-1)\underline{K} = \underline{K}$ and a vector e such that

$$K = \underline{K} + \frac{1}{2}\{e\}.$$

Definition 3.3. The point e will be called the *nigiro*[2] of K and denoted $e(K)$. Moreover, for every zonoid K, we write $\underline{K}$ for the unique zonoid such that $K = \underline{K} + \frac{1}{2}\{e(K)\}$.

We write $\mathscr{Z}(V)$ for the space of zonoids of V and $\mathscr{Z}_0(V)$ for the space of *centered* zonoids, i.e. $\mathscr{Z}_0(V) := \{K \in \mathscr{Z}(V) \,|\, (-1)K = K\}$. By the discussion above we have

$$\mathscr{Z}(V) = \mathscr{Z}_0(V) \oplus V$$

In the sense of the monoid structure given by the Minkowski sum. Elements of $\mathscr{Z}_0(V)$ are called *centered zonoids*.

3.2. **Zonoids and random vectors.** If Λ is a random zonoid in V, that is a map from some probability space to $\mathscr{Z}(V)$, such that $\mathbb{E}|d(0, \Lambda)| < \infty$ then we define the *expected zonoid* $\mathbb{E}\Lambda$ to be the convex body with support function given for all $u \in V^*$ by

$$h_{\mathbb{E}\Lambda}(u) := \mathbb{E}\{h_\Lambda(u)\}.$$

It follows from a strong law of large number for compact sets from [5] that if $\Lambda_1, \ldots, \Lambda_n$ are i.i.d. copies of Λ, then the random zonoid $\frac{1}{n}(\Lambda_1 + \cdots + \Lambda_n)$ converges almost surely as $n \to \infty$ to $\mathbb{E}\Lambda$. In particular the expected zonoid $\mathbb{E}\Lambda$ is indeed a zonoid.

[2]The nigiro $e(K)$ is symmetric to the *origin* with respect to the center of K. In other words, as a vector, it is twice the center of K.

We will, in the following, consider mostly two examples. Let $X \in V$ be a random vector such that $\mathbb{E}\|X\| < \infty$. We say that X is *integrable* and we consider $\mathbb{E}[0, X]$ and $\mathbb{E}\underline{X}$. Their support function is given for all $u \in V^*$ by

$$h_{\mathbb{E}[0,X]}(u) = \mathbb{E}\max\{0, \langle u, X\rangle\}; \qquad h_{\mathbb{E}\underline{X}}(u) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{E}|\langle u, X\rangle|. \tag{17}$$

Next, we show that they are translate of one another.

Lemma 3.4. *Let $X \in V$ be integrable. We have*

$$\mathbb{E}[0, X] = \mathbb{E}\underline{X} + \frac{1}{2}\{\mathbb{E}X\}.$$

With the notation introduced above, this means that $e(\mathbb{E}[0, X]) = \mathbb{E}X$. In particular $\mathbb{E}[0, X] = \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$ if and only if $\mathbb{E}X = 0$.

Proof. It is enough to see that for every $t \in \mathbb{R}$ we have $\max\{0, t\} = \frac{1}{2}(|t| + t)$. Then use the expressions in (17) and the fact that $h_{\{c\}} = \langle \cdot, c\rangle$. □

These constructions behave well under linear mappings.

Lemma 3.5. *Let $X \in V$ be integrable, let W be a finite dimensional Euclidean space and let $T : V \to W$ be a linear map. Then $T(X) \in W$ is integrable and we have*

$$\mathbb{E}[0, T(X)] = T\mathbb{E}[0, X] \qquad \mathbb{E}\underline{T(X)} = T\mathbb{E}\underline{X}$$

Proof. By (17) we have $h_{\mathbb{E}[0,T(X)]}(u) = \mathbb{E}\max\{0, \langle u, T(X)\rangle\} = h_{\mathbb{E}[0,X]}(T^t(u))$. By Theorem 3.1-2 this is the support function of $T\mathbb{E}[0, X]$. The other case is done similarly. □

Example 3.6. Let $x_1, \ldots, x_N \in \mathbb{R}^m$ and let $X \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be the random vector that is equal to Nx_i with probability $1/N$ for $i = 1, \ldots, N$. Then computing the expression in (17), we find,

$$\mathbb{E}[0, X] = \sum_{i=1}^{N}[0, x_i]; \qquad \mathbb{E}\underline{X} = \sum_{i=1}^{N}\underline{x_i}.$$

Example 3.7. Let $\xi \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be a standard Gaussian vector and let B_m be the unit ball of $\mathbb{R}^m$. Then we have

$$\mathbb{E}\underline{\xi} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}}B_m.$$

Indeed, since ξ is $O(m)$–invariant, by Theorem 3.5, $\mathbb{E}\underline{\xi}$ must also be $O(m)$–invariant and thus is a ball. To compute its radius, it is enough to compute the support function at e_1, the first vector of the standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^m$. Since $\langle \xi, e_1\rangle \in \mathbb{R}$ is a standard Gaussian variable, we obtain

$$h_{\mathbb{E}\underline{\xi}}(e_1) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{E}|\langle \xi, e_1\rangle| = \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}}.$$

Vitale in [78, Theorem 3.1] shows that every zonoid can be obtained via the above construction, i.e. for every $K \in \mathscr{Z}(V)$ there is an integrable $X \in V$ and a vector $e \in V$ such that $K = \mathbb{E}\underline{X} + \frac{1}{2}\{e\}$. However, the integrable random vector X defining the zonoid $K := \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$ is not unique. This defines an equivalence relation on the integrable random vectors of a vector space known as the *zonoid equivalence*, see [52]. The following is [52, Corollary 3].

Proposition 3.8. *Let $X, Y \in V$ be integrable. Then $\mathbb{E}\underline{X} = \mathbb{E}\underline{Y}$ if and only if for every one-homogeneous even measurable function $f : V \to \mathbb{R}_+$, we have:*

$$\mathbb{E}\left[f(X)\right] = \mathbb{E}\left[f(Y)\right].$$

This shows that the following is well defined.

Definition 3.9. Let $X \in V$ be an integrable random vector and let $K := \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$. Then the *length* of K is defined to be

$$\ell(K) := \mathbb{E}\|X\|.$$

This functional is actually something very well known, see [7, Theorem 5.2].

Lemma 3.10. *The length of a zonoid is equal to its first intrinsic volume (see (24) below).*

Despite this result, we will continue to use the name *length* and the notation ℓ to emphasize that we are thinking of Theorem 3.9. Since the first intrinsic volume is Minkowski linear and vanishes on zero dimensional bodies we also have, by Theorem 3.4,

$$\ell(\mathbb{E}[0, X]) = \mathbb{E}\|X\|. \tag{18}$$

Finally, there is a simple trick to express the Minkowski sum of two zonoids in terms of random vectors. The proof is straightforward and thus omitted.

Lemma 3.11 (Bernoulli trick)**.** *Let $X_0, X_1 \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be integrable and let $\epsilon \in \{0, 1\}$ be a Bernoulli random variable of parameter $t \in [0, 1]$ independent of X_0 and X_1, that is $\epsilon = 0$ with probability t and $\epsilon = 1$ with probability $1 - t$. Let $X_t := \epsilon X_0 + (1 - \epsilon)X_1$. Then we have*

$$\mathbb{E}[0, X_t] = (1 - t)\mathbb{E}[0, X_0] + t\mathbb{E}[0, X_1]; \qquad \mathbb{E}\underline{X_t} = (1 - t)\mathbb{E}\underline{X_0} + t\mathbb{E}\underline{X_1}.$$

3.3. **Zonoids and measures: the classical viewpoint.** It is most common to approach centered zonoids with even measures on the sphere. We recall here this point of view and describe how this approach relates to Vitale's construction. The space of even signed measures on the unit sphere $S(V)$ is denoted by $\mathcal{M}_{even}(S(V))$ and the cone of non negative even measures by $\mathcal{M}^+_{even}(S(V))$.

It is a classical result (see [68, Theorem 3.5.3]) that for every centered zonoid $K \in \mathscr{Z}_0(V)$ there is a unique $\mu_K \in \mathcal{M}^+_{even}(S(V))$ such that

$$h_K(u) = \frac{1}{2}\int_{S(V)} |\langle u, x\rangle| \, \mathrm{d}\mu_K(x). \tag{19}$$

The function h_K is also called the *cosine transform* of μ_K. We also denote by μ_K the measure on $S(V^*)$ defined by (19) with the scalar product replaced by the duality pairing. If a centered zonoid is given by a random vector, it is possible to retrieve the corresponding measure on the sphere.

Proposition 3.12. *Let $X \in V$ be integrable and let $K := \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$. Then μ_K is the measure such that for every continuous function $f : S(V) \to \mathbb{R}$ we have*

$$\int_{S(V)} f \mathrm{d}\mu_K := \mathbb{E}\left\{\|X\| f\left(\frac{X}{\|X\|}\right)\mathbb{1}_{X\neq 0}\right\} \tag{20}$$

Proof. The function $x \mapsto \|x\| f(\frac{x}{\|x\|})\mathbb{1}_{x\neq 0}$ is a one homogeneous continuous function on V. Thus by Theorem 3.8 the term on the right only depends on K. To see that it satisfies (19) apply it to $f = |\langle u, \cdot\rangle|$ for any $u \in V^*$. □

In particular, note that we have $\mu_K(S(V)) = \ell(K)$. More generally, if $f : V \to \mathbb{R}_+$ is measurable and one homogeneous, we get

$$\mathbb{E}f(X) = \int_{S(V)} f \, d\mu_K \tag{21}$$

where $X \in V$ is integrable and $K := \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$.

3.4. **Zonoid calculus.** In the recent paper [7] the first author together with P. Breiding P. Bürgisser and A. Lerario proved that multilinear maps between vector spaces give rise to multilinear maps on the corresponding spaces of centered zonoids. The following is [7, Theorem 4.1].

Proposition 3.13. *Let $M : V_1 \times \cdots \times V_k \to W$ be a multilinear map between finite dimensional vector spaces. There is a unique Minkowski multilinear continuous map*

$$\widehat{M} : \mathscr{Z}_0(V_1) \times \cdots \times \mathscr{Z}_0(V_k) \to \mathscr{Z}_0(V)$$

such that for all $v_1 \in V_1, \ldots, v_k \in V_k$ we have

$$\widehat{M}\left(\underline{v_1}, \ldots, \underline{v_k}\right) = \underline{M(v_1, \ldots, v_k)}.$$

We extend the map $\widehat{M}$ to general zonoids by setting for all $K_1 \in \mathscr{Z}_0(V_1), \ldots, K_k \in \mathscr{Z}_0(V_k)$ and every $c_1 \in V_1, \cdots, c_k \in V_k$:

$$\widehat{M}\left(K_1 + \frac{1}{2}\{c_1\}, \ldots, K_k + \frac{1}{2}\{c_k\}\right) := \widehat{M}\left(K_1, \ldots, K_k\right) + \frac{1}{2}\left\{M(c_1, \ldots, c_k)\right\}. \tag{22}$$

One can check that this map is still Minkowski multilinear. Moreover, it behaves well under the Vitale construction.

Proposition 3.14. *Let $M : V_1 \times \cdots \times V_k \to W$ be a multilinear map between finite dimensional vector spaces and let $X_1 \in V_1, \ldots, X_k \in V_k$ be integrable and independents. We have*

$$\begin{aligned}\widehat{M}\left(\mathbb{E}\underline{X_1}, \ldots, \mathbb{E}\underline{X_k}\right) &= \underline{\mathbb{E}M(X_1, \ldots, X_k)}; \widehat{M}\big(\mathbb{E}[0, X_1], \ldots, \mathbb{E}[0, X_k]\big) \\ &= \mathbb{E}[0, M(X_1, \ldots, X_k)].\end{aligned}$$

Proof. The first statement about centered zonoids is [7, Corollary 4.3]. The second one follows from it, Theorem 3.4 and (22). □

Consider the exterior powers $\Lambda^k V$, $0 \le k \le m$, where we recall that $m = \dim V$. There is a collection of bilinear maps $\beta_{k,l} : \Lambda^k V \times \Lambda^l V \to \Lambda^{k+l} V$ given for all $w \in \Lambda^k V$, $w' \in \Lambda^l V$ by $\beta_{k,l}(w, w') := w \wedge w'$. We consider the bilinear map induced on zonoids and if $A \in \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k V), A' \in \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^l V)$ we write

$$A \wedge A' := \widehat{\beta_{k,l}}(A, A').$$

We will call this operation the *wedge product of zonoids*. Using Theorem 3.14 we have for X and Y *independent* integrable random vectors:

$$\mathbb{E}\underline{X} \wedge \mathbb{E}\underline{Y} = \mathbb{E}\underline{X \wedge Y}; \qquad \mathbb{E}[0, X] \wedge \mathbb{E}[0, Y] = \mathbb{E}[0, X \wedge Y]. \tag{23}$$

Remark 3.15. Note that the wedge product on centered zonoids is commutative, this follows from (23) and the fact that $\underline{x} = \underline{-x}$.

Finally, in the notation introduced in Theorem 3.3, and using (22), we get that for every zonoids $K \in \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k V), L \in \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^l V)$, we have

$$\underline{K \wedge L} = \underline{K} \wedge \underline{L} \in \mathscr{Z}_0\left(\Lambda^{k+l} V\right) \quad \text{and} \quad e(K \wedge L) = e(K) \wedge e(L) \in \Lambda^{k+l} V.$$

3.5. **Mixed volume and inequalities.** A fundamental result by Minkowski [68, Theorem 5.1.7] states that, given convex bodies $K_1, \ldots, K_m \subset V$, the function $(t_1, \ldots, t_m) \mapsto \mathrm{vol}_m(t_1 K_1 + \cdots + t_m K_m)$ is a polynomial in $t_1, \ldots t_m \ge 0$. The coefficient of $t_1 \cdots t_m$ is called the *mixed volume* of $K_1, \ldots, K_m$ and will be denoted here by $\mathrm{MV}(K_1, \ldots, K_m)$. It relates to the wedge product of zonoids as follows.

Proposition 3.16 ([7, Theorem 5.1])**.** *Let $K_1, \ldots, K_m \in \mathscr{Z}(V)$. We have the following.*

$$\frac{1}{m!}\ell(K_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge K_m) = \mathrm{MV}(K_1, \ldots, K_m).$$

From Minkowski's result, one can also build the *intrinsic volumes* of a convex body $K \subset V$ which are the coefficient (suitably normalized) of the Steiner polynomial $t \mapsto \mathrm{vol}_m(K + tB(V))$ where $B(V) \subset V$ is the unit ball. In our context we define the kth intrinsic volume to be

$$\mathcal{V}_k(K) := \frac{\binom{m}{k}}{b_{m-k}} \mathrm{MV}(K[k], B(V)[m-k]) \tag{24}$$

where $K[k]$ denotes the convex body K repeated k times in the argument.

From the previous Proposition, one can deduce the following, which is [7, Theorem 5.2] and will be used later in the proof of Theorem 7.3.

Proposition 3.17. *Let $K \in \mathscr{Z}(V)$. We have the following.*

$$\frac{1}{k!}\ell\left(K^{\wedge k}\right) = \mathcal{V}_k(K)$$

Moreover for all $k > \dim(K)$, $K^{\wedge k} = 0$.

Moreover the support function on simple vectors takes the following form which will be used in Theorem 9.8 to link zonoid calculus to the notion of *Holmes-Thompson volume*.

Lemma 3.18. *Let $K \in \mathscr{Z}_0(V)$ be a centered zonoid and let $u = u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k \in \Lambda^k V$. We have*

$$h_{K^{\wedge k}}(u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k) = \frac{\|u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k\|}{2} k! \,\mathrm{vol}_k(\pi_u(K))$$

where $\pi_u : V \to \mathrm{Span}(u_1, \ldots, u_k)$ denotes the orthogonal projection.

Proof. Let $X \in V$ be such that $K = \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$ and let $X_1, \ldots, X_k$ be iid copies of X. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}h_{K^{\wedge k}}(u) &= \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{E}\left|\langle X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k, u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k\rangle\right| \\ &= \frac{\|u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k\|}{2}\,\mathbb{E}\|\pi_u(X_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \pi_u(X_k)\| \\ &= \frac{\|u_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge u_k\|}{2}\ell\left(\pi_u(K)^{\wedge k}\right).\end{aligned}$$

Finally, by Theorem 3.16, we have $\ell(\pi_u(K)^{\wedge k}) = k!\,\mathrm{vol}_k(\pi_u(K))$ which concludes the proof. □

3.5.1. *Alexandrov–Fenchel and Brunn–Minkowski inequalities.* One of the most important inequality of convex geometry (if not the most important) involves the mixed volume and is known as the *Alexandrov–Fenchel inequality* (AF), see [68, Theorem 7.3.1].

Proposition 3.19 (AF)**.** *Let $K_3, \dots, K_m \subset V$ be convex bodies and let us denote by $\mathfrak{K}$, the tuple $(K_3, \dots, K_m)$. For all convex bodies $K, L \subset V$ we have*

$$\mathrm{MV}(K, L, \mathfrak{K}) \geq \sqrt{\mathrm{MV}(K, K, \mathfrak{K})\,\mathrm{MV}(L, L, \mathfrak{K})}.$$

Another inequality bounds from below the volume of the Minkowski sum of two convex bodies and is known as the *Brunn–Minkowski inequality* (BM). It has many equivalent form and we chose to present here the multiplicative one, see [68, p. 372 (e)].

Proposition 3.20 (BM)**.** *Let $K_0, K_1 \subset V$ be convex bodies. For all $t \in [0, 1]$, we have*

$$\mathrm{vol}_m((1-t)K_0 + tK_1) \geq \mathrm{vol}_m(K_0)^{1-t}\,\mathrm{vol}_m(K_1)^t.$$

3.6. **Grassmannian zonoids.** The zonoids that will appear in the construction of the zonoid section below (see Theorem 5.1) belong to a particular subset of $\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k V)$. Recall that if V is Euclidean then $\Lambda^k V$ inherits an Euclidean structure given for all $v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k, w_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge w_k \in \Lambda^k V$ by

$$\langle v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k, w_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge w_k \rangle := \det\left(\langle v_i, w_j \rangle\right)_{1 \leq i,\, j \leq k}.$$

Vectors of the form $v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \in \Lambda^k V$ are said to be *simple*.

We write $G(k, V)$ for the Grassmannian of k–dimensional subspaces of V. Recall that the Grassmannian embeds in the projective space of $\Lambda^k V$ via the Plücker embedding that sends $E \in G(k, V)$ to $[e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_k] \in \mathbb{P}(\Lambda^k V)$ where $e_1, \dots, e_k$ is a basis of E. In particular the set of simple vectors in $\Lambda^k V$ can be viewed as the cone over the Grassmannian and a measure on $G(k, V)$ can be identified with an even measure on $S(V)$ supported on the simple vectors.

For every $E \in G(k, V)$ we define the segment

$$\underline{E} := \underline{e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_k} \subset \Lambda^k V$$

where $e_1, \dots, e_k$ is an orthonormal basis of E.

Definition 3.21. A zonoid $K \in \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k V)$ is a *Grassmannian zonotope* if there exists subspaces $E_1, \dots, E_n \in G(k, V)$ scalars $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n \geq 0$ and a simple vector $c = c_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge c_k \in \Lambda^k V$ such that $K = \lambda_1 \underline{E_1} + \cdots + \lambda_n \underline{E_n} + \frac{1}{2}\{c\}$. A *Grassmannian zonoid* is a limit of Grassmannian zonotopes. We denote the set of Grassmannian zonoids in $\Lambda^k V$ by $\mathcal{G}(k, V) \subset \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k V)$ and centered Grassmannian zonoids by $\mathcal{G}_0(k, V) := \mathcal{G}(k, V) \cap \mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k V)$.

Remark 3.22. For $k \in \{0, 1, m-1, m\}$ where $m := \dim V$, all zonoids are Grassmannian.

The following lemma clarifies how to recognize Grassmannian zonoids when represented by random vectors or by measures. In particular, centered Grassmannian zonoids in $\Lambda^k V$ correspond to positive measures on $G(k, V)$.

Lemma 3.23. *Let $K \in \mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k V)$. The following are equivalent.*

(i) *$K \in \mathcal{G}_0(k, V)$;*
(ii) *There is an integrable random vector $X \in \Lambda^k V$ that is almost surely simple, i.e. such that almost surely $X = X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k$ (the vectors $X_1, \dots, X_k$ can be* dependent*), such that $K = \mathbb{E}\underline{X}$*
(iii) *The support of the measure $\mu_K \in \mathcal{M}^+_{even}(S(\Lambda^k V))$ is contained in the intersection of $S(\Lambda^k V)$ with the set of simple vectors, i.e. $\mu_K \in \mathcal{M}^+(G(k, V))$.*

Proof. The equivalence (ii) $\iff$ (iii) follows from Theorem 3.12. The equivalence (i) $\iff$ (iii) follows from the fact that Hausdorff convergence of zonoids corresponds to weak–$*$ convergence of measures [7, Theorem 2.26 (5)]. □

Remark 3.24. As it will be clear from Theorem 5.1, Theorem 3.23 (ii) implies that the value at $p \in M$ of the zonoid section ζ_X of a *z-KROK* field $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is a Grassmannian zonoids: $\zeta_X(p) \in \mathcal{G}(k, T_p M)$ for all $p \in M$.

Remark 3.25. From (iii) we see that $\mathcal{G}_0(k, V) \cong \mathcal{M}^+(G(k, V))$.

It is not difficult, using (iii), to see that the Grassmannian zonoids are closed under the Minkowski sum. Similarly, one can see using (ii) that they are also closed under the wedge product.

Lemma 3.26. *The wedge product, respectively the Minkowski sum, of two Grassmannian zonoids is a Grassmannian zonoid.*

The next lemma makes computations easier for Grassmannian zonoids and, for instance, it can be used to compute directly the constant in the proof of Theorem 6.2. We will use it in the proof of Theorem 6.6.

Lemma 3.27. *Let $C \in \mathcal{G}(k, \mathbb{R}^m)$ and let $B_m := B_{\mathbb{R}^m}$ be the unit ball of $\mathbb{R}^m$. Then we have*

$$\ell(C) = \frac{1}{(m-k)! b_{m-k}} \ell\left(C \wedge B_m^{\wedge(m-k)}\right)$$

where $b_d := \mathrm{vol}_d(B_d)$.

Proof. Since the length is translation invariant, we can assume C is centered. Let $C = \mathbb{E}\underline{X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k}$, let $Y \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be a Gaussian vector of mean 0 and variance $\sqrt{2\pi}$ in such a way that $B_m = \mathbb{E}\underline{Y}$ and let $Y_1, \ldots, Y_{m-k}$ be iid copies of Y independents of $X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k$. Then using the independence of the random variables and the fact that $Y_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge Y_{m-k}$ is orthogonal invariant we have

$$\begin{aligned}\ell\left(C \wedge B_d^{\wedge(d-k)}\right) &= \mathbb{E}\|X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k \wedge Y_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge Y_{m-k}\| \\ &= \mathbb{E}\|X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k\| \cdot \mathbb{E}\|e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_k \wedge Y_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge Y_{m-k}\|\end{aligned}$$

where $e_1, \ldots, e_m$ denotes the standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^m$. We obtain

$$\ell\left(C \wedge B_m^{\wedge(m-k)}\right) = \ell(C) \cdot \mathbb{E}\|\pi(Y_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \pi(Y_{m-k})\|$$

where $\pi : \mathbb{R}^m \to \mathbb{R}^{m-k}$ is the orthogonal projection onto $\mathrm{Span}(e_{k+1}, \ldots, e_m)$. Then it remains only to see, using Theorem 3.17, that

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}\|\pi(Y_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \pi(Y_{m-k})\| &= \ell\left(\pi(B_m)^{\wedge(m-k)}\right) \\ &= \ell\left((B_{m-k})^{\wedge(m-k)}\right) \\ &= (m-k)! b_{m-k}.\end{aligned}$$

□

Finally, we observe the following. Let $f : G(k, V) \to \mathbb{R}$ be a measurable function and denote also by f its (even and) homogeneous extension on the cone of simple vectors. Then if $K = \mathbb{E}\underline{X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k}$ is a Grassmannian zonoid with generating measure $\mu_K \in \mathcal{M}^+(G(k, V))$, we get that (21) becomes:

$$\mathbb{E}f(X_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge X_k) = \int_{G(k,V)} f \, d\mu_K. \tag{25}$$

3.7. **Topology of zonoids.** We conclude this introduction to zonoids with a short comment on zonoid bundles. It will be useful to keep in mind this section in what follows, to understand the continuity of the zonoid section (Theorem 5.1). Let M be a manifold of dimension m and let $\pi : E \to M$ be a topological vector bundle of rank k. The structure of vector bundle is given by the *trivialization maps* $\chi_U : E|_U \xrightarrow{\sim} U \times \mathbb{R}^k$ which are homeomorphisms that are linear isomorphism on the fibers.

We can define the zonoid bundle $\mathscr{Z}(E)$ whose fiber at a point $p \in M$ is defined to be $\mathscr{Z}(E)_p := \mathscr{Z}(E_p)$ where E_p is the fiber of E at p, and whose bundle structure is given by the collection of maps $\widehat{\chi_U} : \mathscr{Z}(E)|_U \xrightarrow{\sim} U \times \mathscr{Z}(\mathbb{R}^k)$ in particular the topology on $\mathscr{Z}(E)$ is the smallest topology that makes all $\widehat{\chi_U}$ homeomorphisms. Recall that the space of zonoids $\mathscr{Z}(\mathbb{R}^k)$ is topologized by the Hausdorff distance, see (16). Similarly one can define $\mathscr{Z}_0(E)$, $\mathcal{G}(k, E)$, $\mathcal{G}_0(k, E)$.

Given a fiber bundle $\pi : F \to M$ we denote by $\Gamma(F)$ the space of continuous sections of F, that is $\gamma \in \Gamma(F)$ if and only if $\gamma : M \to F$ is a continuous map such that for every $p \in M$, $\pi(\gamma(p)) = p$. In particular a section $\zeta \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(E))$ is the choice of a zonoid at each point p of the manifold M in the vector space E_p such that this zonoid depends *continuously* on the point p. We will call ζ a *zonoid section*.

We observe then that a section ζ of the bundle $\mathscr{Z}(E) \to M$ defines at each point $p \in M$ a continuous positively homogeneous sublinear function $h_{\zeta(p)} : E_p^* \to \mathbb{R}$.

Lemma 3.28. *ζ is continuous if and only if the map $h_\zeta : E^* \to \mathbb{R}, (p, u) \mapsto h_{\zeta(p)}(u)$ is a continuous function on E^*.*

Proof. It is sufficient to prove the statement locally, thus we assume $E = \mathbb{R}^m \times \mathbb{R}^k$. Consider the space $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^k)$ endowed with the compact-open topology. This has the property that: $h \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^m \times \mathbb{R}^k)$ if and only if $h_1 \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^m, \mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^k))$, where $h_1 : p \mapsto h(p, \cdot)$. Therefore, the statement translates into proving that a sequence of zonoids $\zeta_n \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ converges to a limit ζ if and only if the corresponding sequence of support functions $h_n \colon \mathbb{R}^k \to \mathbb{R}$ converges to $h := h_\zeta$ in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbb{R}^k)$ with respect to the compact-open topology. Now, we recall that h_n and h are positively homogeneous functions, which implies that $h_n \to h$ if and only if the same convergence holds for the restrictions to the sphere S^{k-1}. The compact-open topology of $\mathcal{C}(S^{k-1})$ coincides with the one induced by the supremum norm, hence we conclude by (16). □

Theorem 3.28 will be used in § 5 to show the continuity of the zonoid section.

We conclude this section with some observations regarding the space of zonoid sections, with the only scope of giving a more complete picture. In fact, it is easy to turn the latter proof into a proof of the following statement. Linearity is meant with respect to the Minkowski sum on the left and follows from Theorem 3.1.

Proposition 3.29. *The assignment $\zeta \mapsto h_\zeta$ defines a linear topological embedding*

$$h_\cdot : \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(E)) \hookrightarrow \mathcal{C}(E^*),$$

Remark 3.30. The exact image of $h_\cdot$ is not easy to determine, but it is certainly contained in the subset of functions that are sublinear on fibers, see Section 3.

A further observation is that, as fiber bundles, we have $\mathscr{Z}(E) \cong \mathscr{Z}_0(E) \oplus E$ and thus

$$\Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(E)) \cong \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(E)) \oplus \Gamma(E). \tag{26}$$

Therefore we can, as before, treat the *nigiro* (see Theorem 3.3) of a zonoid and the centered zonoid as separate continuous sections.

4. *z-KROK* hypotheses

Let (M, g) be a smooth Riemannian manifold of dimension $m \in \mathbb{N}$, possibly non-compact. In this section we are going to describe a class of random functions $X : M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$ for which Kac–Rice formula works well and it can be written in terms of a *field of zonoids* as explained in Section 1.

Definition 4.1 (*z-KROK* hypotheses)**.** Let $X \colon M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$ be a random map. We say that X is *z-KROK* if the following properties hold.

(1) $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$.
(2) Almost surely, 0 is a regular value of X.
(3) For any $p \in M$ the probability $[X(p)]$ on $\mathbb{R}^k$ is absolutely continuous with density denoted as $\rho_{X(p)} \colon \mathbb{R}^k \to [0, +\infty)$.
(4) The function $\rho_X \colon M \times \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ given by $\rho_X(p, x) = \rho_{X(p)}(x)$ is continuous at $(p, 0)$ for all $p \in M$.
(5) There exists a regular conditional probability $\mu(p, x) \in \mathscr{P}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$ of X given $X(p)$ (see § 4.1 below) such that the following holds. Let $J_p \cdot \mu(p, x) \in \mathcal{M}^+(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$ be the measure defined by

$$J_p \cdot \mu(p, x)(B) = \int_B J_p f \cdot d\left(\mu(p, x)\right)(f).^3$$

Then we ask that $J_p \cdot \mu(p, x)$ is a finite measure and that the function

$$\begin{aligned} J_M \cdot \mu : M \times \mathbb{R}^k &\to \mathcal{M}^+\left(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)\right) \\ (p, x) &\mapsto J_p \cdot \mu(p, x) \end{aligned}$$

is continuous at $(p, 0)$ for all $p \in M$.

These hypotheses are exactly what we need to apply the Kac–Rice formula to express the expectation of quantities of the form:

$$I_\alpha(X) := \int_{X^{-1}(0)} \alpha(p, X) dM(p),$$

where $\alpha \colon M \times \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to \mathbb{R}$ is a measurable function, see Theorem 6.2. They are a variation of the KROK hypotheses introduced in [74]: a series of hypotheses on pairs (X, W), where $X \colon M \to N$ is a random map and $W \subset N$ is a submanifold of codimension $m = \dim M$. If (X, W) is KROK, then the measure $\mu(A) := \mathbb{E}\#(X^{-1}(W) \cap A)$ is computed by a generalized Kac–Rice formula, see [74, Theorem 2.2]. In this paper, we only consider the case when $W = \{0\} \subset N = \mathbb{R}^k$ but we do not impose conditions on its codimension k.

The precise relation between the KROK hypotheses of [74] and the *z-KROK* hypotheses of Definition 4.1 is that X is *z-KROK* if and only if the pair $(X, \{0\})$ satisfies all conditions KROK.(ℓ) for all $\ell \in \{\text{i}, \ldots, \text{vii}\} \smallsetminus \{\text{v}\}$ in [74, Definition 2.1]. Indeed KROK (v) is a codimension assumption and it translates to our setting as the condition: $k = m$, which is not required for X to be *z-KROK*. The hypothesis KROK (vii) is equivalent to *z-KROK* (5) by point (3) of Proposition 4.6 below, that is a more precise version of [74, Prop. 2.4]. See also Section A to compare with the hypotheses that appear in the more standard statements of Kac–Rice formulas, [4, 6].

[3] In the distributional sense, it is the multiplication of the measure $\mu(p, x)$ with the function $J_p \colon f \mapsto J_p f$.

Remark 4.2. Although having a Riemannian metric g on M is useful to state *z-KROK*.5, the notion does not depend on g: If X is *z-KROK* on (M, g) then it is *z-KROK* on $(M, \widetilde{g})$ for any Riemannian metric $\widetilde{g}$. This is easily seen by the fact that the functions J_p and $\widetilde{J}_p$ corresponding to the two metrics are related by an identity: $J_p = \varphi(p)\widetilde{J}_p$ for some smooth function $\varphi \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(M, (0, +\infty))$.

Remark 4.3. The hypothesis *z-KROK* (2) can be verified in some cases using the generalization of Bulinskaya Lemma proved in [6, Prop. 6.12]. This says that if $X \in \mathcal{C}^2(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and the triple $(p, X(p), d_pX)$ has a joint density $\rho\colon J^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to \mathbb{R}$, where $J^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is the first jet bundle, that is bounded on a compact neighborhood of each point $(p, 0, A) \in J^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, then *z-KROK* (2) holds.

4.0.1. *A comment about the notation.* The notation *KROK*, introduced in [74], stands for *Kac-Rice OK*. Here, we add the letter z for two reasons: to remind that we only care about the *zeroes* and to indicate that some *zonoid* will appear. *z-KROK* is pronounced "skrok", "zkrok" or "zee krok".

4.1. **Remarks on *z-KROK* (5).** Given a random element $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and a point $p \in M$, a *regular conditional probability*[4] of X given $X(p)$ is a function

$$\mu(p, \cdot)(\cdot)\colon \mathbb{R}^k \times \mathcal{B}\left(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)\right) \to [0, 1], \qquad (x, B) \mapsto \mu(p, x)(B)$$

that satisfies the following two properties, see [26] (The definition for any fixed p as it depends only on the pair of random variables X and $X(p)$).

(a) For every $B \in \mathcal{B}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$, the function $\mu(p, \cdot)(B)\colon \mathbb{R}^k \to [0, 1]$ is Borel and for every $V \in \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}^k)$, we have

$$\mathbb{P}\{X \in B; X(p) \in V\} = \int_V \mu(p, x)(B) d[X(p)](x) \tag{27}$$

where recall that $[X(p)]$ denotes the probability measure that is the law of the random vector $X(p) \in \mathbb{R}^k$.

(b) For all $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$, $\mu(p, x)$ is a Borel probability measure on $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$.

The fact that the space $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is Polish ensures that, for every $p \in M$, a regular conditional probability measure $\mu(p, \cdot)(\cdot)$ of X given $X(p)$ exists (see [26, Theorem 10.2.2]) and it is unique up to $[X(p)]$-a.e. equivalence on $\mathbb{R}^k$. However, strictly speaking, it is not a well defined function of p, although the notation can mislead to think that.

According to the above definition, there are many different choices of measures $\mu(p, x) \in \mathscr{P}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$ with the property that $\mu(p, \cdot)(\cdot)$ is a regular conditional probability of X given $X(p)$, for all fixed $p \in M$. In our case such ambiguity may be traumatic, since we will be interested in the value of $\mu(p, x)$ at $x = 0$ which, by *z-KROK* (3), is negligible for the measure $[X(p)]$, i.e. $\mathbb{P}\{X(p) = 0\} = 0$. Therefore, it is essential to choose a family of regular conditional probabilities $\{\mu_p\}_{p \in M}$ that has at least some continuity property at $(p, x) \to (p_0, 0)$. This is the motivation for the hypothesis *z-KROK* (5).

4.2. **Notation for conditioned random maps.** We will use the notation of random elements, in the following sense. If $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is *z-KROK*, then for any $(p, x) \in M \times \mathbb{R}^k$, we write

$$(X|X(p) = x) \in \mathcal{C}^1\left(M, \mathbb{R}^k\right)$$

for any random element representing the measure $\mu(p, x)$, i.e. such that $[X|X(p) = x] = \mu(p, x)$. Hence $(X|X(p) = x)$ is not a well defined random element but since in the sequel everything will only depend on the *law* this will not be a problem. Moreover, we will write

$$\mathbb{P}\left\{X \in B | X(p) = x\right\} := \mathbb{P}\left\{(X|X(p) = x) \in B\right\} = \mu(p, x)(B),$$

for every $B \subset \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X)|X(p) = x\right\} := \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha((X|X(p) = x))\right\} = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)} \alpha(f) d\mu(p, x)(f).$$

for every $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to \mathbb{R}$ measurable, whenever the integral, called *expectation* in this context, makes sense. If X is *z-KROK* then the probability $\mu(p, 0)$ is unique, so the notation $[X|X(p) = x]$ is not ambiguous at $x = 0$. More precisely, if $\mu(p, x)$ and $\mu'(p, x)$ are two regular conditional probabilities of X given $X(p)$ satisfying *z-KROK* (5) then $\mu(p, 0) = \mu'(p, 0)$. For all the other $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$, we will abuse the notation.

The following observation is often useful in computations.

[4] See [26] or [86]. In the latter the same object is called a *regular version of the conditional probability*.

Remark 4.4. Let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ and let $p \in M$. If d_pX and $X(p)$ are stochastically independent, then the law of the random vector d_pX is a regular conditional probability of d_pX given $X(p)$, therefore we have that the two laws are equivalent:

$$[d_pX] = [d_pX|X(p) = x], \quad \text{for } [X(p)]\text{-almost every } x \in \mathbb{R}^k.$$

In particular, if X is *z-KROK*, the continuity of $\mu(p,x)$ at $x = 0$ yields

$$[d_pX] = [d_pX|X(p) = 0].$$

Therefore, in this case the zonoid section at p is computed by:

$$\zeta_X(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{\left[0, d_pX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_pX^k\right]\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0).$$

4.2.1. *The notation makes sense.* The Lemma below has the scope to clarify some doubts that often arise when using the notation explained above.

Lemma 4.5. *Let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ and fix $p \in M$. Let $\mu(p,\cdot)(\cdot)$ be a regular conditional probability for X given $X(p)$. Then $\mu(p,x)$ is supported on $\{f \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)\colon f(p) = x\}$ for $[X(p)]$-a.e. $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$, that is, in the above notation,*

$$\mathbb{P}\left\{X(p) = x \;\middle|\; X(p) = x\right\} = 1, \quad \textit{for } [X(p)]\textit{-a.e. } x \in \mathbb{R}^k.$$

Proof. Let us fix $p \in M$. Let $V \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ be a Borel subset and define $B_V := \{f \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k) | f(p) \in V\}$. Then, by Equation (27), we have that

$$\int_V d[X(p)](x) = \mathbb{P}\{X(p) \in V\} = \mathbb{P}\{X \in B_V\} = \int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \mu(p,x)(B_V) d[X(p)](x).$$

It follows that there is a Borel subset $N_V \subset \mathbb{R}^k$, with $\mathbb{P}\{X(p) \in N_V\} = 1$ such that for every $x \in N_V$, we have

$$1_V(x) = \mu(p,x)(B_V) = \mathbb{P}\{X(p) \in V | X(p) = x\}.$$

Let $\{V_n\}_{n\in\mathbb{N}}$ be a countable basis of the topology of N. Let $B_n = B_{V_n} \subset \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ be defined as above. Then $\cap_n N_{V_n} := N' \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ is still a full measure set for $[X(p)]$. Clearly, we have that every singleton $x \in N$, can be written as a countable intersection

$$\{x\} = \bigcap_{\{n\in\mathbb{N}\colon x\in V_n\}} V_n.$$

Moreover, for every $x \in N'$ and every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, we have that $\mu(p,x)(B_n) = 1_{V_n}(x)$. Therefore, if $x \in N'$, then we conclude by the continuity from above of the measure $\mu(p,x)$:

$$\mathbb{P}\{X(p) = x | X(p) = x\} = \mu(p,x)\left(B_{\{x\}}\right) = \inf_{\{n\in\mathbb{N}\colon x\in V_n\}} 1_{V_n}(x) = 1. \qquad \square$$

4.3. **Equivalent formulations of *z-KROK* (5).** We derive a more technical version of the hypothesis *z-KROK* (5). See also Section A.

Proposition 4.6. *Let $X : M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$ be a random map satisfying* z-KROK-(1)-(4) *and let $\mu(p,\cdot)(\cdot) =: [X|X(p) = \cdot](\cdot)$ be a regular conditional probability of X given $X(p)$ (See § 4.1). The following statements are equivalent:*

1. *(*z-KROK *(5)) The function $J_M \cdot \mu : M \times \mathbb{R}^k \to \mathcal{M}^+(\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k))$ is continuous at $(p,0)$ for all $p \in M$.*
2. *For any bounded continuous function $\alpha \in \mathcal{C}_b(\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k);\mathbb{R})$ and any convergent sequence $(p_n,x_n) \to (p,0)$ in $M \times \mathbb{R}^k$ we have*

$$\mathbb{E}\{\alpha(X)J_{p_n}X \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\} \to \mathbb{E}\{\alpha(X)J_pX \,|\, X(p) = 0\}.$$

3. *For any bounded continuous function $\alpha \in \mathcal{C}_b(\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k) \times M;\mathbb{R})$, the function*

$$M \times \mathbb{R}^k \ni (p,x) \mapsto \mathbb{E}\{\alpha(X,p)J_pX \,|\, X(p) = 0\}$$

   is finite and continuous at $(p,0)$ for every $p \in M$.
4. *For any sequence of continuous functions $\beta_n \to \beta_0 \in \mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k);\mathbb{R})$ that converges in the compact-open topology and any sequence $(p_n,x_n) \to (p_0,0)$ converging in $M \times \mathbb{R}^k$ such that $\beta_n(f) \le CJ_{p_n}f$ for some $C > 0$, we have that*

$$\mathbb{E}\{\beta_n(X) \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\} \to \mathbb{E}\{\beta_0(X) \,|\, X(p_0) = 0\}. \tag{28}$$

Proof. (1) $\iff$ (2) by definition. Moreover, it is clear that (4) $\implies$ (3) $\implies$ (2), so that it will be sufficient to show that (1) $\implies$ (4). In [74, Proposition 2.4] it was proven that (1) $\implies$ (3), but a slight modification of the same argument allows to obtain the (apparently) stronger statement (4). We are going to repeat it here, with some extra care, to prove the Proposition.

Assume (1) and let $\beta_n, p_n, x_n \to \beta_0, p_0, 0$ as in the statement of (4). Observe that for all $\beta = \beta_n$ and $p = p_n$, if $J_p f = 0$, then $\beta(f) = 0$, so that

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{E}\left\{\beta(X) \,|\, X(p) = x\right\} \\
&\qquad = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \beta(f) d\mu(p,x)(f) \\
&\qquad = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)\smallsetminus\{J_p=0\}} \beta(f)\frac{J_p f}{J_p f} d\mu(p,x)(f) + \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)\cap\{J_p=0\}} \beta(f) d\mu(p,x)(f) \\
&\qquad = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \frac{\beta(f)}{J_p f} d\left(J_p \cdot \mu(p,x)\right)(f).
\end{aligned}$$

Notice that the last term makes sense because $J_p \cdot \mu(p,x)(\{J_p = 0\}) = 0$.

Let $E(p,x) := \mathbb{E}\{J_p X | X(p) = x\}$ be the total mass of the measure $J_p \cdot \mu(p,x)$. By *z-KROK* (5), the number $E(p,0) \geq 0$ is finite, though notice that it could be zero (See Theorem 4.8). The hypothesis (1) implies that $E(p_n, x_n) \to E(p,0)$. If $E(p_0,0) = 0$, then the limit (28) holds since

$$\left|\mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_n(X) \,\middle|\, X(p_n) = x_n\right\}\right| \leq C E(p_n, x_n) \to 0 = \mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_0(X) \,\middle|\, X(p_0) = 0\right\}.$$

Assume that $E(p_0,0) > 0$, then we can assume that $E(p_n,x_n) > 0$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. In this case, the next sequence of probabilities converges:

$$P_n := E(p_n,x_n)^{-1} J_{p_n} \cdot \mu(p_n,x_n) \to P_0 := E(p_0,0)^{-1} J_{p_0} \cdot \mu(p_0,0).$$

Thus by Skorohod's Theorem (See [13, 63]) there exists a sequence of random functions $Y_n, Y_0 \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ defined on a common probability space such that $Y_n \to Y_0$ in $\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ almost surely. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_n(X) \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\right\} &= E(p_n,x_n) \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \frac{\beta_n(f)}{J_{p_n} f} dP_n(f) \\
&= E(p_n,x_n)\mathbb{E}\left\{\frac{\beta_n(Y_n)}{J_{p_n} f}\right\} \to E(p_0,0)\mathbb{E}\left\{\frac{\beta_0(Y)}{J_{p_0} f}\right\} \\
&= E(p_0,0) \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \frac{\beta_0(f)}{J_{p_0} f} dP_0(f) \\
&= \mathbb{E}\left\{\beta(X) \,|\, X(p) = 0\right\}.
\end{aligned}$$

Here the limit holds by dominated convergence, since $\frac{\beta_n(Y_n)}{J_{p_n} f} \leq C$ and $\frac{\beta_n(Y_n)}{J_{p_n} f} \to \frac{\beta_0(Y_0)}{J_{p_0} f}$ almost surely. □

To show that a given random field verifies *z-KROK* (5), it is often convenient to check directly that it satisfies point (2) of Theorem 4.6 above, which is equivalent to *z-KROK*-5 by definition. On the other hand, the apparently stronger formulation given in point (4) is the one that we will refer to in the subsequent proofs, in order to deduce other properties of *z-KROK* fields. We also note that *z-KROK* (5) is an equivalent formulation of property KROK(vii) of [74, Definition 2.1], that is point (3).

Remark 4.7. Theorem 4.6 is based on the same principle as the theorem of Banach–Steinhaus [18, Chapter 2].

Example 4.8. There are examples of random maps $X \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R})$ that are *z-KROK*, thus in particular

$$\mathbb{P}\left\{X(p) = 0 \implies J_p X > 0, \forall\, p \in M\right\} = 1,$$

but for which there are points $p \in M$ with $\mathbb{E}\left\{J_p X | X(p) = 0\right\} = 0$. It is possible to build such examples on any manifold M by generalizing the following construction.

Let $\gamma_1, \gamma_2 \sim N(0,1)$ be independent normal Gaussians. Define $X \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(\mathbb{R},\mathbb{R})$ as

$$X(u) := u^2\gamma_1 + \gamma_2.$$

By Theorem 4.10, in the next subsection, the field X is *z-KROK* and the probability $\mu(u_0,0)$ is represented by the random field such that $(X(u)|X(u_0) = 0) = (u^2 - u_0^2)\gamma_1$. Thus, $\mathbb{E}\left\{J_0 X | X(0) = 0\right\} = 0$. See also § 10.2.

4.4. **The Gaussian case.** Assume that the random map $X\colon M \overset{\Omega}{\to} \mathbb{R}^k$ is Gaussian, see [4, 45]. As it should be expected, in this case the *z-KROK* hypotheses are much simpler, in particular *z-KROK* (5) is automatically satisfied.

Proposition 4.9. *Let X be a Gaussian random field on M with values in $\mathbb{R}^k$ such that*

(1) *$X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$;*
(2) *Almost surely, 0 is a regular value of X;*
(3) *For any $p \in M$ the Gaussian vector $X(p) \in \mathbb{R}^k$ is non-degenerate:*

$$\det \mathbb{E}\left\{X(p)X(p)^T\right\} \neq 0;$$

Then X is z-KROK.

Proof. In [74, Section 9.1] the author uses [74, Lemma 9.1] to prove the validity of *z-KROK*.5, in the equivalent form reported in Proposition 4.6, point (3). □

Actually, the requirement that 0 is almost surely a regular value is, in many cases, redundant. We already seen that when $X \in \mathcal{C}^2$, one can use the generalized Bulinskaya lemma, see Remark 4.3. However, in the Gaussian case, if the field is smooth[5] then by [45, Theorem 7] we have that (3) implies (2). This can be thought as a manifestation of Sard's theorem (see [33]), so that it should not be surprising that a regularity higher than $\mathcal{C}^1$ is required[6].

[5]The requirement that $X \in \mathcal{C}^r$ for r large enough would be sufficient, however, the authors do not know precisely *how large* r should be.

[6]Sard's theorem [66] states that the set of critical values of a map $f\colon \mathbb{R}^m \to \mathbb{R}^k$ of class $\mathcal{C}^r$ has measure zero, provided that $r \geq 1 + \max\{0, m-k\}$.

Proposition 4.10. *Let X be a Gaussian random field on M with values in $\mathbb{R}^k$ such that*

(1) $X \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$;
(2) *For any $p \in M$ the Gaussian vector $X(p) \in \mathbb{R}^k$ is non-degenerate:*

$$\det \mathbb{E}\left\{X(p)X(p)^T\right\} \neq 0;$$

Then X is z-KROK.

Proof. Combine Proposition 4.9 with [45, Theorem 7] as discussed above. □

5. The zonoid section

We are now ready to define the main object of this paper. We recall, from § 3.7 that a zonoid section $\zeta \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^*M))$ is the choice of a zonoid at each point p of the manifold M in the vector space $\Lambda^k T_p^* M$ such that this zonoid depends *continuously* on the point p.

Definition 5.1. Let $X = (X^1, \dots, X^k) \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be *z-KRoK*. The associated *zonoid section* $\zeta_X \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^*M))$ is defined for every $p \in M$ by

$$\zeta_X(p) := \mathbb{E}\left\{ \left[0, \mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right] \;\middle|\; X(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0).$$

The fact that this definition is well posed, i.e. that the section ζ_X is indeed continuous, is a consequence of Theorem 5.2 below. This definition has to be intended in the following sense: let $[X|X(p) = 0] = \mu(p, 0)$ be the probability measure implied by the *z-KROK* condition and represented by a random map $(X|X(p) = 0) \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, as explained in § 4.2. Then we consider the random covector $(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k | X(p) = 0) =: Y \in \Lambda^k T_p^* M$ and form the random segment $[0, Y] \subset \Lambda^k T_p^* M$. This is, in particular, a random zonoid and we can take its expectation as explained in § 3.2 (we will see that $\mathbb{E}\|Y\| < +\infty$ in a moment), and build the zonoid $\zeta_X(p) \subset \Lambda^k T_p^* M$ having support function $h_{\zeta_X(p)} \colon \Lambda^k T_p M \to \mathbb{R}$ given, for every $u \in \Lambda^k T_p M$, by

$$h_{\zeta_X(p)}(u) = \rho_{X(p)}(0) \mathbb{E} \max\left\{0, \langle Y, u\rangle\right\}.$$

We denote by $h_{\zeta_X} : \Lambda^k TM \to \mathbb{R}$ the function given by $(p, u) \mapsto h_{\zeta_X(p)}(u)$. The following property is a useful consequence of the *z-KROK* hypotheses. (see equation (17) and the precedent discussion.)

Proposition 5.2. *$h_{\zeta_X} : \Lambda^k TM \to \mathbb{R}$ is continuous.*

Proof. Let $(p_n, u_n) \to (p_0, u_0)$ be a converging sequence in $\Lambda^k TM$. Define $\beta_n \colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to \mathbb{R}$ as

$$\beta_n(f) := \max\left\{0, \left\langle d_{p_n} f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_{p_n} f^k, u_n \right\rangle\right\} \rho_{X(p_n)}(0).$$

Clearly β_n is continuous and, by *z-KROK* (3), it converges: $\beta_n \to \beta_0$ in the compact-open topology of $\mathcal{C}\left(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k); \mathbb{R}\right)$. Moreover, since u_n converges and $p \mapsto \rho_{X(p)}(0)$ is continuous, there exists a constant $C > 0$ such that

$$\beta_n(f) \leq \left|\rho_{X(p_n)}(0)\right| \left\|d_{p_n} f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_{p_n} f^k\right\| \, \|u_n\| \leq C J_{p_n} f.$$

Applying Theorem 4.6, with $x_n = 0$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n \to +\infty} h_{\zeta_X(p_n)}(u_n) &= \lim_{n \to +\infty} \mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_n(X) \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\right\} \\ &= \mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_0(X) \,|\, X(p_0) = 0\right\} \\ &= h_{\zeta_X(p_0)}(u_0). \end{aligned}$$

□

By Theorem 3.28 this ensures that the function $\zeta_X \colon M \to \mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^*M)$ is indeed continuous and that Theorem 5.1 was well posed: $\zeta_X \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^*M))$.

5.1. The Pull-back property.

We now establish a simple and very useful criteria for building *z-KROK* maps out of others in a seemingly functorial way. This is also reminiscent of a property of the characteristic classes of vector bundles.

Theorem B. Let $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be *z-KROK*. Let S be a smooth manifold and let $\varphi \colon S \to M$ be a smooth map such that $\varphi \pitchfork X^{-1}(0)$ almost surely. Then $X \circ \varphi \in C^1(S, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is *z-KROK* and

$$\zeta_{X\circ\varphi}(q) = d_q \varphi^* \zeta_X(\varphi(q)), \quad \forall\, q \in S. \tag{29}$$

Proof. Assuming the first part of the statement, the formula (29) is obvious from the definition of ζ_X. To prove the theorem we have to show that the random map $X \circ \varphi$ satisfies all the five properties of Theorem 4.1, with respect to any Riemannian metric on S.

(1) $X \circ \varphi \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, by definition.
(2) The fact that 0 is a regular value of $X \circ \varphi$ is completely equivalent (under the condition that 0 is a regular value of X) to the hypothesis $\varphi \pitchfork X^{-1}(0)$.

(3) For $q \in S$, the probability $[(X \circ \varphi)(q)] = [X(\varphi(q))]$ on $\mathbb{R}^k$ has density $\rho_{(X\circ\varphi)(q)}(\cdot)\colon \mathbb{R}^k \to [0, +\infty]$, where $\rho_{(X\circ\varphi)(q)}(x) := \rho_{X(\varphi(q))}(x)$.

(4) Since φ is continuous and ρ_X is continuous at $(p, 0)$, it follows that $\rho_{X\circ\varphi}$ is continuous at $(q, 0)$ for any $q \in S$.

(5) Let $\mu(p, x) := [X|X(p) = x] \in \mathscr{P}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$ be the regular conditional probability on $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ associated to the *z-KROK* random map X. By assumption, the function

$$J_M \cdot \mu\colon M \times \mathbb{R}^k \to \mathcal{M}^+\left(\mathcal{C}^1\left(M, \mathbb{R}^k\right)\right)$$

is continuous at $(p, 0)$. Let $\varphi^*\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to \mathcal{C}^1(S, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be the function given by $\varphi^*(f) := f \circ \varphi$. This is continuous with respect to the $\mathcal{C}^1$ topologies and we define $\nu(q, x) := \varphi^*_{\#}\mu(\varphi(q), x)$ to be the push-forward of $\mu(\varphi(q), x)$ via φ^*. So $\nu(q, x)$ is the probability measure such that for every measurable function $F\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \to [0, +\infty]$, we have

$$\int_{\mathcal{C}^1(S,\mathbb{R}^k)} F(g)d\nu(q, x)(g) = \mathbb{E}\left\{F(\varphi^*(X)) \,|\, X(\varphi(p)) = x\right\}.$$

From this, one can see that $\nu(q, \cdot)(\cdot)$ is a regular conditional probability of $X \circ \varphi$ given $(X \circ \varphi)(q)$ (see § 4.1). Indeed, for every $B \in \mathcal{B}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k))$, by taking $F := 1_B$, we see that

$$\nu(q, x)(B) = \mathbb{P}\left\{X \circ \varphi \in B \,|\, X(\varphi(p)) = x\right\}$$

is Borel measurable with respect to $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$ and for any $V \in \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{R}^k)$, by taking $F(g) := 1_B(g)1_V(g(q))$ we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}(30)\quad \mathbb{P}\left\{X \circ \varphi \in B; (X \circ \varphi)(q) \in V\right\} &= \mathbb{E}\left\{1_B(X \circ \varphi)1_V(X(\varphi(q)))\right\} \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \mathbb{E}\left\{1_B(X \circ \varphi)1_V(X(\varphi(q))) \,|\, X(\varphi(p)) = x\right\} d[X(\varphi(p))](x) \\ &= \int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \nu(q, x)(B)d[(X \circ \varphi)(p)](x),\end{aligned}$$

so that Property (a) is proven. Moreover, it is obvious by the construction that $\nu(q, x)$ is a Borel probability, indeed it follows by the measurability of the function f^*, thus Property (b).

At this point, we proved that for any $q \in S$, we have the regular conditional probability $\nu(q, \cdot)(\cdot)$. To conclude the proof we have to show the continuity of $J_q \cdot \nu(q, x)$ at $(q, 0)$. Let $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(S, \mathbb{R}^k) \to [0, 1]$ be continuous. Let $(q_n, x_n) \to (q, 0)$ be a converging sequence in $S \times \mathbb{R}^k$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}(31)\quad &\int_{\mathcal{C}^1(S,\mathbb{R}^k)} \alpha(g)(J_{q_n}g)d\nu(q_n, x_n)(g) \\ &\qquad = \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X \circ \varphi)\left(J_{q_n}(X \circ \varphi)\right) \,|\, X(\varphi(q_n)) = x_n\right\} = \dots\end{aligned}$$

Observe that the normal Jacobians satisfy the inequality

$$J_{q_n}(X \circ \varphi) \le J_{\varphi(q_n)}X \cdot J_{q_n}\varphi \le C \cdot J_{\varphi(q_n)}X,$$

where the last inequality is due to the facts that the sequence q_n is contained in a compact subset of S and that $J_q\varphi$ is continuous in q, because $\varphi \in \mathcal{C}^1$.

It follows that we can apply Theorem 4.6 to the sequence of points $(p_n, x_n) := (\varphi(q_n), x_n)$ and the continuous functions β_n defined as

$$\beta_n(f) := \alpha\left(f \circ \varphi\right) J_{q_n}(f \circ \varphi) \to \alpha(f \circ \varphi)J_q(f \circ \varphi).$$

The above sequence converges in the compact-open topology of $\mathcal{C}_b(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k); \mathbb{R})$. Indeed, since $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is metrizable, this is equivalent to say that whenever $f_n \to f$ in $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, then $\beta_n(f_n) \to \beta(f)$. Now, $f_n \to f$ converges in $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ if and only if $j^1_{q_n} f_n \to j^1_q f$ in $J^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ for every converging sequence $q_n \to q$, thus, in particular, $J_{q_n} \to J_q f$, since $J_q f$ depends continuously on $j^1_q f$. By Theorem 4.6 we get that (31) becomes

$$\cdots = \mathbb{E}\left\{\beta_n(X) \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\right\} \to \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X \circ \varphi)J_q(X \circ \varphi), \,|\, X \circ \varphi(q) = 0\right\},$$

which proves the thesis. □

5.2. **Independent intersection and wedge product.** If $X_1 \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ and $X_2 \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^l)$ are two *z-KROK* fields, one can build another random field $Y = (X_1, X_2) \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^{k+l})$ whose zero set is the intersection of the previous two zero sets: $Y^{-1}(0) = X_1^{-1}(0) \cap X_2^{-1}(0)$. In the case where X_1 and X_2 are independent, we prove that the zonoid section of the new field is the wedge product of the previous zonoid sections.

Theorem C. Let $X_1 \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ and $X_2 \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^l)$ be independent *z-KROK* fields. Let $Y := (X_1, X_2) \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^{k+l})$ and assume that $Y \pitchfork 0$ almost surely. Then, Y is *z-KROK* and we have for all $p \in M$

$$\zeta_Y(p) = \zeta_{X_1}(p) \wedge \zeta_{X_2}(p).$$

Proof. Conditions *z-KROK* (1) to (4) are immediately satisfied, note that since X_1 and X_2 are independent we have for all $x_1 \in \mathbb{R}^k$, $x_2 \in \mathbb{R}^l$ and all $p \in M$: $\rho_{Y(p)}(x_1,x_2) = \rho_{X_1(p)}(x_1)\rho_{X_2(p)}(x_2)$. To see that *z-KROK*(5) is satisfied it is enough to see that if $\mu_i(\cdot,\cdot)$ is a regular conditional probability for X_i then $\mu(p,(x_1,x_2)) := \mu_1(p,x_1) \otimes \mu_2(p,x_2)$ is a regular conditional probability of Y given $Y(p)$. With such choice of μ, one can prove that Y satisfies *z-KROK*(5), by repeating the reasoning used in the proof of Theorem B. In particular, in the notation introduced in § 4.2, we have that for all $p \in M$, the random vectors $(X_1|X_1(p)=0)$ and $(X_2|X_2(p)=0)$ are independent.

Now it remains to observe that by definition of the field Y, we have for all $p \in M$:

$$\mathrm{d}_pY^1 \wedge \cdots \mathrm{d}_pY^{k+l} = \left(\mathrm{d}_pX_1^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_pX_1^k\right) \wedge \left(\mathrm{d}_pX_2^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_pX_2^l\right).$$

Hence, using Equation (23), we have

$$\rho_{Y(p)}(0)\left[0, \mathrm{d}_pY^1 \wedge \cdots \mathrm{d}_pY^{k+l}\right] = \left(\rho_{X_1(p)}(0)\left[0, \mathrm{d}_pX_1^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_pX_1^k\right]\right) \wedge \left(\rho_{X_2(p)}(0)\left[0, \mathrm{d}_pX_2^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_pX_2^l\right]\right). \tag{32}$$

The result then follows by taking expectations on both sides and from the independence observed earlier. □

5.3. **Bernoulli combination and Minkowski sum.** Another simple operation on random fields allows to build the convex combination of the zonoid sections.

Proposition 5.3. *Let $X_0, X_1 \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ be* z-KROK *and let $\epsilon \in \{0,1\}$ be a Bernoulli random variable of parameter $t \in [0,1]$ independent of X_0 and X_1, that is $\epsilon = 0$ with probability t and $\epsilon = 1$ with probability $1-t$. Assume, in addition, that*

$$(*) \qquad \text{there is no point } p \in M \text{ such that } \rho_{X_i}(p,0) = 0 \text{ for both } i = 0,1.$$

Let $X_t := \epsilon X_0 + (1-\epsilon)X_1$. Then $X_t \in C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ is z-KROK *and we have for all $p \in M$*

$$\zeta_{X_t}(p) = (1-t)\zeta_{X_0}(p) + t\zeta_{X_1}(p).$$

Proof. The properties *z-KROK*(1) to (4) are satisfied by X_t and observe that for all $p \in M$, we have $\rho_{X_t(p)} = (1-t)\rho_{X_0(p)} + t\rho_{X_1(p)}$. Let $\mu_i(p,x)$ be a regular conditional probability for X_i given $X_i(p)$, $i = 0,1$. We prove that

$$\mu_t(p,x) := \frac{(1-t)\rho_{X_0(p)}(x)\mu_0(p,x) + t\rho_{X_1(p)}(x)\mu_1(p,x)}{\rho_{X_t(p)}(x)} \tag{33}$$

is a regular conditional probability for X_t given $X_t(p)$. Indeed, let $B \subset C^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)$ and $V \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ be Borel subsets, then, by definition of X_t, we have for all $p \in M$,

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{P}\left(X_t \in B;\ X_t(p) \in V\right) &= (1-t)\mathbb{P}\left(X_0 \in B;\ X_0(p) \in V\right) + t\mathbb{P}\left(X_1 \in B;\ X_1(p) \in V\right)\\ &= \int_V \left((1-t)\mu_0(p,x)(B)\rho_{X_0(p)}(x) + t\mu_1(p,x)(B)\rho_{X_1(p)}(x)\right)\mathrm{d}x\end{aligned}$$

where the first equality follows from the definition of X_t and the second from the property of conditional probabilities given in (27). And thus we obtain

$$\mathbb{P}\left(X_t \in B;\ X_t(p) \in V\right) = \int_V \mu_t(p,x)(B)\rho_{X_t(p)}(x)\mathrm{d}x.$$

Moreover $\mu_t(p,x)$ is a probability measure for all $p \in M$, $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$ thus it is a regular conditional probability for X_t. The hypothesis $(*)$ guarantees that μ_t satisfies *z-KROK*(5), since μ_0 and μ_1 do. Finally, the result follows from the fact that $\rho_{X_t(p)}(0)\mu_t(p,0) = (1-t)\rho_{X_0(p)}(0)\mu_0(p,0) + t\rho_{X_1(p)}(0)\mu_1(p,0)$ for all $p \in M$. □

Remark 5.4. The hypothesis $(*)$ in Theorem 5.3 is what allows to avoid the difficulties coming from the denominator in (33) when proving that X_t satisfies *z-KROK* (5). It is not a necessary condition, although in general the field X_t may fail to be *z-KROK*.

Remark 5.5. We believe that the *z-KROK* Hypotheses, as stated in Theorem 4.1, are a bit more restricting than necessary. Indeed, the continuity condition in (5) could probably be replaced by the weaker conditions that the product $(p,x) \mapsto \rho_{X(p)} J_p \cdot \mu(p,x)$ is continuous at $(p,0)$ for all $p \in M$ and that $E(p,x) = \mathbb{E}\{J_p X | X(p) = x\}$ is locally bounded, without affecting the results of the paper except for Theorem 5.3, in which the hypothesis $(*)$ could be dropped, and Theorem 10.1 which we will discuss in § 10 below.

6. The Alpha formula

We will use the following version of Kac–Rice formula to deduce all our results. This is obtained as a particular case of [74]. See Appendix A for a detailed comparison with the standard statements of Kac–Rice formula in [6] and [4]. The only differences are in the hypotheses, in particular the statement below is almost identical to [6, Theorem 6.7].

Proposition 6.1 (α-Kac–Rice formula)**.** *Let (M,g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension $m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let $F\colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^m$ be a* z-KROK *random field. Let $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^m) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ be a Borel measurable function. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{ \sum_{p \in F^{-1}(0)} \alpha(F,p) \right\} = \int_M \delta_F^\alpha(p) dM(p). \tag{34}$$

Where

$$\delta_F^\alpha(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{ \alpha(F,p) J_p F \,|\, F(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{F(p)}(0),$$

and where both sides of (34) *and $\delta_F^\alpha(p)$ take values in $\mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty, -\infty, \infty - \infty\}$.*

Proof. In the language of [74, Theorem 4.1], if F is *z-KROK* with values in $\mathbb{R}^{\dim M}$, then the pair $(F, \{0\})$ is *KROK*. □

The name Kac–Rice formula is often used to denote also a more general version of Theorem 6.1 which allows to deal with the case in which $X^{-1}(0)$ is not zero dimensional, see [6, Theorem 6.8]. The additional flexibility provided by Theorem 6.2 below is crucial for us, since we want to be able to build a framework of calculus for intersections of random submanifolds $X^{-1}(0)$ of arbitrary codimension.

Theorem 6.2 (Alpha Formula)**.** *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M,g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $X\colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^k$ be a* z-KROK *random field and define the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Let $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ be a Borel measurable function. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{ \int_Z \alpha(X,p) dZ(p) \right\} = \int_M \delta_X^\alpha(p) dM(p). \tag{35}$$

Where

$$\delta_X^\alpha(p) := \mathbb{E}\left\{ \alpha(X,p) J_p X \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0), \tag{36}$$

and where both sides of (35) *and $\delta_X^\alpha(p)$ take values in $\mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty, -\infty, \infty - \infty\}$.*

The proof will be given later, in § 6.2, after some preliminaries. In [6, Theorem 6.10] the analogous statement for Gaussian fields is reported mentioning that the proof follows the same lines as in the case $m = k$. Here, to prove its validity under our *z-KROK* hypotheses, we are going to use a different strategy. We are going to prove that, with little work and using the Pull-back property (Theorem B), Theorem 6.2 is a natural consequence of Theorem 6.1. This method of proof is new and interesting in that it shows how it's always possible to reduce everything to the zero dimensional case using the construction, by Adler and Taylor [4], of Gaussian fields that represent the Riemannian structure, see § 6.1. Moreover, it is fully in the spirit of this work to investigate the relations between the various Kac–Rice formulas.

6.1. The Adler–Taylor metric and normal fields.

In [4, Section 12] Adler and Taylor introduced and developed the concept of the Riemannian metric induced by a sufficiently regular random field $\mathbb{y}\colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}$ on a smooth manifold:

$$g_{AT}^{\mathbb{y}}(p)(v,w) = \mathbb{E}\left\{ d_p\mathbb{y}(v) \cdot d_p\mathbb{y}(w) \right\}. \tag{37}$$

We will refer to $g_{AT}^{\mathbb{y}}$ as *the Adler–Taylor metric* induced by $\mathbb{y}$. Given a Riemannian manifold (M,g), it will be very useful for us to express g as the Adler-Taylor metric induced by some smooth Gaussian field with unit variance.

Definition 6.3. Let (M, g) be a Riemannian manifold and $\mathbb{y} \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(M)$ be a smooth Gaussian random field. We will say that $\mathbb{y}$ is a *normal field* on (M, g) if $\mathbb{y}(p) \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$ for every $p \in M$ and $g = g^{\mathbb{y}}_{AT}$. In this case we will write $\mathbb{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(M, g)$.

Remark 6.4. The law of the normal field $\mathbb{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(M, g)$ is not uniquely determined. It depends exactly on the choice of an isometric immersion of (M, g) into the sphere of an Hilbert space. By Nash's isometric embedding theorem, every smooth Riemannian manifold (M, g) admits a normal field $\mathbb{y}$ with finite dimensional support $\operatorname{supp}(\mathbb{y}) \subset \mathcal{C}^\infty(M, \mathbb{R})$. See also [4] and [56].

By Theorem 6.3, it is clear that if $\mathbb{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(M, g)$ then for every smooth submanifold $Z \subset M$ with induced metric $g|_Z$ we have $\mathbb{y}|_Z \sim \mathcal{N}(Z, g|_Z)$. This property, together with the following lemma makes the normal field a very good tool to express integrals over the manifold.

Lemma 6.5. *Let (M, g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m, let $\mathbb{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(M, g)$ and let $Y^1, \dots, Y^m$, be i.i.d. copies of $\mathbb{y}$. Define the random discrete set $\Sigma := \{Y^1 = \cdots = Y^m = 0\}$. Let $\alpha \colon M \to \mathbb{R}$ be Borel with compact support. Then we have*

$$\int_M \alpha(p) = \frac{s_m}{2} \mathbb{E}\left\{ \sum_{p \in \Sigma} \alpha(p) \right\}$$

where recall that $s_m := \operatorname{vol}_m(S^m)$.

Proof. Let $Y = (Y^1, \dots, Y^m) \colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^m$. First note that, since $Y(p) \sim N(0, \mathbb{1}_m)$ for all $p \in M$, by differentiating $\mathbb{E}\{|Y^i(p)|^2\} = 1$ with respect to p we see that the random vectors $Y(p)$ and d_pY are independent. By Theorem 6.1, we have that

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{ \sum_{p \in \Sigma} \alpha(p) \right\} = \int_M \alpha(p) \mathbb{E}\left\{ J_pY \,|\, Y(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{N(0,1)}(0) dM(p) = c(m) \int_M \alpha(p) dM(p)$$

where the last equality is due to two facts: the first is that for any fixed $p \in M$, the random vectors $Y(p)$ and d_pY are independent; the second is that in an orthonormal frame, all the rows of d_pY are identically distributed standard Gaussian vectors in $\mathbb{R}^m$.

Now, the constant $c(m)$ can be computed by writing more carefully the formula, but there is a quicker way. The above identity should be true in the case when $M = S^m$, $\alpha = 1$ and $\mathbb{y} \colon S^m \looparrowright \mathbb{R}$ is a normal field on S^m defined as $\mathbb{y}(p) = \langle \gamma, p \rangle$ for $\gamma \sim N(0, \mathbb{1}_m)$. In such case Σ is almost surely a pair of antipodal points, thus

$$c(m) = \frac{1}{s_m} \mathbb{E}\#\Sigma = \frac{2}{s_m}. \qquad \square$$

6.2. **Proof of the Alpha Formula (Theorem 6.2).** Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$ and let

$$X \colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^k$$

be a *z-KROK* field. Let $d := m - k$, let $Y^1, \dots, Y^d \sim \mathcal{N}(M, g)$ be i.i.d. normal fields independent of X and let $Y := (Y^1, \dots, Y^d) \colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^d$. We write $Z := X^{-1}(0)$ and $\Sigma := Y^{-1}(0)$ and we let $F := (X, Y) \colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^m$.

6.2.1. *Intersection with a normal field.* By Theorem C, F is *z-KROK*. By integrating first with respect to Y, using the independence of X and Y, we deduce the following identity from Theorem 6.1:

$$\mathbb{E} \int_Z \alpha(X, p) = \frac{s_d}{2} \mathbb{E}\left\{ \sum_{p \in \Sigma \cap Z} \alpha(X, p) \right\} = \dots \tag{38}$$

Now, we apply Theorem 6.1 with $\alpha(F, p) := \alpha(X, p)$ depending only on the first factor and (38) becomes

$$\cdots = \frac{s_d}{2} \int_M \delta^\alpha_F(p) dM(p). \tag{39}$$

It remains only to show that $\frac{s_d}{2} \delta^\alpha_F = \delta^\alpha_X$.

6.2.2. *The constant doesn't matter.* Once again, we don't need to keep track of the constants as long as they depend only on k and m. Indeed, we can argue as in the proof of Theorem 6.5 and observe that if the identity

$$\mathbb{E}\int_Z \alpha(X,p) = c(m,k)\int_M \delta_X^\alpha(p)dM(p) \tag{40}$$

holds under the hypotheses of Theorem 6.2, then we can check the constant in the case when $M = S^m$, $\alpha = 1$ and $X = (X^1, \dots, X^k)$ is such that $X^i(p) = \langle \gamma_i, p\rangle$ for a family of k i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors $\gamma_i \sim N(0, \mathbb{1}_{m+1})$. Such random field is invariant under orthogonal transformations, therefore δ_X^1 is a constant, hence we can compute it at $p = e_0$ the first vector of the canonical basis of $\mathbb{R}^{m+1}$. Since, in this case, Z is almost surely a unit sphere of dimension d, we obtain the identity

$$s_d = c(m,k)s_m\delta_X^1(e_0) = c(m,k)s_m\mathbb{E}\left\{\left|J_0\begin{pmatrix}\gamma_1 & \dots & \gamma_k\end{pmatrix}\right| \,\middle|\, \gamma_i^0 = 0\right\}\frac{1}{(2\pi)^{\frac{k}{2}}},$$

from which we deduce, using Theorem 6.6 below, that

$$c(m,k)^{-1} = \frac{s_m}{s_d}\mathbb{E}\left\{\|\xi_1\wedge\dots\wedge\xi_k\|\right\}\frac{1}{(2\pi)^{\frac{k}{2}}} = 1$$

where $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_k \sim N(0, \mathbb{1}_m)$ are i.i.d.

Lemma 6.6. *Let $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_k \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors. We have:*

$$\mathbb{E}\,\|\xi_1\wedge\dots\wedge\xi_k\| = \frac{m!b_m}{(2\pi)^{\frac{k}{2}}(m-k)!b_{m-k}} = (2\pi)^{\frac{k}{2}}\frac{s_{m-k}}{s_m}$$

Proof. We will prove the lemma using zonoid calculus, as discussed in Section 3. First, by Theorem 3.7, we have that $\mathbb{E}\underline{\xi_i} = (2\pi)^{-\frac{1}{2}}B^m$ for all $i = 1, \dots, m$. It follows then from Theorem 3.9 that

$$\mathbb{E}\|\xi_1\wedge\dots\wedge\xi_k\| = (2\pi)^{-\frac{k}{2}}\ell\left((B^m)^{\wedge k}\right) = \dots. \tag{41}$$

Observe that B^m is a Grassmannian zonoid, hence, by using first Theorem 3.27 and then Theorem 3.17, (41) becomes

$$\dots = (2\pi)^{-\frac{k}{2}}\frac{1}{(m-k)!b_{m-k}}\ell\left((B^m)^{\wedge m}\right) = (2\pi)^{-\frac{k}{2}}\frac{1}{(m-k)!b_{m-k}}m!b_m$$

which gives the first equality we wanted. The second follows from the identity $d!b_d = (2\pi)^d s_d$. □

Remark 6.7. Theorem 3.17 implies that in the setting of Theorem 6.6 above we have

$$\mathbb{E}\,\|\xi_1\wedge\dots\wedge\xi_k\| = (2\pi)^{-\frac{k}{2}}k!\mathcal{V}_k(B^m). \tag{42}$$

6.2.3. *Computing the density.* In virtue of the identities (38) and (39), to prove the identity (40), it is sufficient to show that

$$\delta_F^\alpha(p) = c(m,k)\delta_X^\alpha(p),$$

for some constant $c(m,k)$ depending only on m and k. (Since we already showed that the constant doesn't matter, we will keep calling it with the same letter $c(m,k)$ even though its value changes from line to line.) Since X and Y are independent, we have that $\rho_{F(p)}(0) = \rho_{X(p)}(0)\rho_{Y(p)}(0) = c(m,k)\rho_{X(p)}(0)$. Moreover, observe that d_pY and $Y(p)$ are independent. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned}\delta_F^\alpha(p) &= \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X,p)J_pF \,|\, F(p) = 0\right\}\rho_{F(p)}(0)\\ &= c(m,k)\mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X,p)\left\|d_pX^1\wedge\dots\wedge d_pX^k\wedge d_pY^1\wedge\dots\wedge d_pY^d\right\| \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\}\\ &\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\rho_{X(p)}(0) = \dots\end{aligned} \tag{43}$$

Recall that taking coordinates with respect to an orthonormal basis of T_p^*M, we have that $d_pY^1, \dots, d_pY^d$ become i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors in $\mathbb{R}^m$, so that, by integrating first with respect to Y and using Theorem 6.8 below, we obtain that (43) becomes

$$\begin{aligned}\dots &= c(m,k)\mathbb{E}_X\left\{\alpha(X,p)\mathbb{E}_Y\left\{\left\|d_pX^1\wedge\dots\wedge d_pX^k\wedge d_pY^1\wedge\dots\wedge d_pY^d\right\|\right\}\right.\\ &\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\qquad\left.\Big| X(p) = 0\right\}\rho_{X(p)}(0)\\ &= c(m,k)\mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X,p)\left\|d_pX^1\wedge\dots\wedge d_pX^k\right\| \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\}\rho_{X(p)}(0)\\ &= \delta_X^\alpha(p)\end{aligned}$$

which is what we wanted.

Lemma 6.8. *Let $\xi_1, \dots, \xi_d \in \mathbb{R}^m$ be i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors and let $v_1, \dots, v_k \in \mathbb{R}^m$. Then there exists a constant $c(m,k) > 0$ s.t.*

$$\mathbb{E}\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \wedge \xi_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \xi_d\| = c(m,k)\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\|$$

Proof. Let $e_1, \dots, e_m$ be an orthonormal basis. We can assume that $v_1, \dots, v_k$ belong to the space generated by $e_1, \dots, e_k$. Let us denote by $\pi\colon \mathbb{R}^m \to \mathbb{R}^m$, the orthogonal projection onto the space spanned by $e_{k+1}, \dots, e_m$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}\,\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \wedge \xi_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \xi_d\| &= \mathbb{E}\,\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \wedge \pi(\xi_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \pi(\xi_d)\| \\ &= \|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\| \cdot \mathbb{E}\|\pi(\xi_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \pi(\xi_d)\|\,.\end{aligned}$$

This concludes the proof of the lemma, because $\pi(\xi_i)$ are now independent standard Gaussian vectors in a space of dimension $m-k$. □

7. Main results

7.1. **The density of expected volume.** Taking $\alpha = 1$ in Theorem 6.2, we obtain the formula for the expected volume of a random submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0)$. In this case, abusing notation, we write

$$\delta_Z(p) := \delta_X(p) := \delta_X^1(p),$$

where $\delta_X^1(p)$ is defined by (36), with $\alpha \equiv 1$.

Theorem 7.1 (Expected volume)**.** *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M,g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $X\colon M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$ be a* z-KROK *random field and define the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Let $A \subset M$ be a Borel subset. Then*

$$\delta_Z(p) = \ell\left(\zeta_X(p)\right) \tag{44}$$

and thus

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\mathrm{vol}_d(Z \cap A)\right\} = \int_A \ell\left(\zeta_X(p)\right) dM(p).$$

Proof. By Theorem 6.2, we have that

$$\delta_Z(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{\left\|d_pX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_pX^k\right\| \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0)$$

is the density of the measure $A \mapsto \mathbb{E}\{\mathrm{vol}_d(Z \cap A)\}$. By definition of the zonoid section (Theorem 5.1) and by (18), this is precisely equal to $\ell(\zeta_X(p))$, which is what we wanted. □

Notice that, since $J_pX = \|d_pX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_pX^k\|$, (44) is the first of the two identities in (4).

We introduce the following notion of transversality.

Definition 7.2. We say that a set of *z-KROK* fields $X_1, \dots, X_k$ is *multi-transverse* if, for any $l_1, \dots, l_k \in \mathbb{N}$, given independent fields X_{ij}, with $i \in \{1, \dots, k\}$ and $j \in \{1, \dots, l_i\}$, such that $X_{ij} \sim X_i$, we have that the field

$$(X_{11}, \dots, X_{1l_1}, \dots, X_{k1}, \dots, X_{kl_k}) \tag{45}$$

satisfies *z-KROK* (2) (hence is *z-KROK* by Theorem C). in particular, a field X is *multi-transverse* if the set formed by only $X_1 = X$ itself is multi-transverse.

Let us use the convention that $\mathrm{vol}_n(\emptyset) := 0$ for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $\mathrm{vol}_n(Z) = +\infty$ if $Z \neq \emptyset$ and $n < 0$. Using the expression for independent intersection described in Theorem C we find the following.

Corollary 7.3. *Let $X_1 \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^{k_1}), \dots, X_n \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^{k_n})$ be independent multi-transverse* z-KROK *fields, write $k := k_1 + \cdots + k_n$ and let $Z_i := (X_i)^{-1}(0)$, $i = 1, \dots, n$. Then we have, for all $p \in M$,*

$$\delta_{Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_n}(p) = \ell(\zeta_{X_1}(p) \wedge \ldots \wedge \zeta_{X_n}(p)). \tag{46}$$

In other words, for all $U \subset M$ measurable we have

$$\mathbb{E}\,\mathrm{vol}_{m-k}\left(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_n \cap U\right) = \int_U \ell(\zeta_{X_1}(p) \wedge \ldots \wedge \zeta_{X_n}(p)) dM(p) \tag{47}$$

In the case where $k_i = 1$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$ and were $n = m = \dim M$, we have

$$\mathbb{E}\#\left(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_m \cap U\right) = m! \int_U \mathrm{MV}(\zeta_{X_1}(p), \dots, \zeta_{X_m}(p)) dM(p), \tag{48}$$

where MV *denotes the mixed volume, see § 3.5. In the case in which $k_i = 1$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$ and all the fields are identically distributed, we have*

$$\mathbb{E}\,\mathrm{vol}_{m-n}\left(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_n \cap U\right) = n! \int_U \mathcal{V}_n(\zeta_{X_1}(p))dM(p), \tag{49}$$

where we recall that $\mathcal{V}_n$ denotes the nth intrinsic volume defined in (24)*; if, in addition, $n = m = \dim M$, then*

$$\mathbb{E}\#\left(Z_1 \cap \cdots \cap Z_m \cap U\right) = m! \int_U \mathrm{vol}_m(\zeta_{X_1}(p))dM(p). \tag{50}$$

Proof. As we mentioned above, (47) follows by combining Theorem 7.1 with Theorem C. In the case where $k_i = 1$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$, and where $n = m = \dim M$, we have $k = n$, so that by Theorem 3.16, (47) specializes to (48). If all the fields are identically distributed and scalar: $k_1 = \cdots = k_n = 1$, then their zonoid sections coincide and thus (47) becomes (49) by Theorem 3.17. Finally, if $n = m$ we obtain (50) as a special case of either (48) or (49). □

7.2. **Alexandrov–Fenchel and Brunn–Minkowski inequalities for random submanifolds.** Applying the inequalities (AF) and (BM) (Theorems 3.19 and 3.20) we obtain lower bounds for the densities.

Theorem D (KRAF)**.** Let $Y_1, \dots, Y_{m-2}, X_1, X_1', X_2, X_2' \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be independent multi-transverse *z-KROK* fields, such that $X_1' \sim X_1$ and $X_2' \sim X_2$. Let $\mathfrak{Z} := (Y_1)^{-1}(0) \cap \ldots \cap (Y_{m-2})^{-1}(0)$, $Z_i := (X_i)^{-1}(0)$ and $Z_i' := (X_i')^{-1}(0)$. Then we have for all $p \in M$

$$\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_2 \cap \mathfrak{Z}}(p) \geq \sqrt{\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_1' \cap \mathfrak{Z}}(p) \cdot \delta_{Z_2 \cap Z_2' \cap \mathfrak{Z}}(p)}.$$

Remark 7.4. Note that Theorem D is an inequality on the densities and not directly on the number of points of intersection. In fact, by Hölder's inequality, we have that

$$\sqrt{\mathbb{E}\#\left(Z_1 \cap Z_1'\right) \cdot \mathbb{E}\#\left(Z_2 \cap Z_2'\right)} \geq \int_M \sqrt{\delta_{Z_1 \cap Z_1' \cap \mathfrak{Z}}(p) \cdot \delta_{Z_2 \cap Z_2' \cap \mathfrak{Z}}(p)}.$$

Theorem E (KRBM)**.** Let $X_0, X_1 \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be multi-transverse *z-KROK* fields, let $\epsilon \in \{0, 1\}$ be a Bernoulli of parameter $0 \leq t \leq 1$ independents of X_0, X_1, i.e. $\epsilon = 0$ with probability $(1 - t)$and 1 with probability t. Let $X_t := (1 - \epsilon_i)X_0 + \epsilon X_1$ be *z-KROK*[7]. Finally, let $Z_1^{(i)}, \dots, Z_m^{(i)}$ be i.i.d. copies of $(X_i)^{-1}(0)$, $i = 0, 1, t$. We have for all $p \in M$:

$$\delta_{Z_1^{(t)} \cap \cdots \cap Z_m^{(t)}}(p) \geq \left(\delta_{Z_1^{(0)} \cap \cdots \cap Z_m^{(0)}}(p)\right)^{(1-t)} \left(\delta_{Z_1^{(1)} \cap \cdots \cap Z_m^{(1)}}(p)\right)^{t}.$$

7.3. **The expected current.** Assume that M is oriented. Then a *z-KROK* field $X \colon M \multimap \mathbb{R}^k$ defines a random $(m - k)$-current, by integration over the random (co-oriented and thus oriented, see Theorem 7.5) submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0)$:

$$\int_Z : \Omega_c^{(m-k)}(M) \to \mathbb{R}$$

where recall that $\Omega_c^{(m-k)}(M)$ is the space of smooth differential forms of degree $m-k$ with compact support.

Definition 7.5. The orientation of $Z = X^{-1}(0)$ is defined by declaring that if $\lambda \in \Lambda^{m-k} T_p^* M$ is such that $\lambda \wedge d_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p X^k > 0$, then $\lambda|_Z > 0$.

In this subsection, we will prove that the expectation of this random current is the current represented by the continuous k-form $e_X \in \Gamma(\Lambda^k T^* M) \subset \Omega_c^{m-k}(M)^*$, which is the *nigiro* (see Theorem 3.3) of the zonoid section:

$$e_X(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{d_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p X^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0) = e(\zeta_X).$$

Proposition 7.6. *e_X is a continuous k-form: $e_X \in \Gamma(\Lambda^k T^* M)$.*

Proof. Given a zonoid ζ in a fixed vector space V, its nigiro $e(\zeta)$ can be expressed as

$$e(\zeta) = \sum_{i=1}^{m} \frac{h_\zeta(v_i) - h_\zeta(-v_i)}{2} v^i,$$

where $v_1, \dots, v_m$ is a basis of V and $v^1, \dots, v^m$ is the dual basis. Indeed, one can check that this formula is true for segments and is linear and continuous in h_ζ. Hence, $e(\zeta)$ depends continuously on the support function h_ζ. Thus, the thesis follows from Theorem 5.2. □

[7]For instance, this is true if the condition $(*)$ of Theorem 5.3 holds.

Theorem 7.7 (Expected current)**.** *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M, g) be an oriented Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $X\colon M \looparrowright \mathbb{R}^k$ be a* z-KROK *random field and consider the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0)$, oriented according to Theorem 7.5. Let $\omega \in \Omega_c^{(m-k)}(M)$. Then, the random variable $\int_Z \omega|_Z$ is integrable and*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega|_Z\right\} = \int_M \omega \wedge e_X. \tag{51}$$

Proof. Let $d = m - k$. Let us define $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ as follows: if $f(p) \neq 0$ or if p is a critical point of f, then $\alpha(f, p) = 0$; otherwise we set

$$\alpha(f, p) := \langle \omega(p), e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_d \rangle, \tag{52}$$

where $e_1, \ldots, e_d$ is a positive orthonormal basis of $T_p(f^{-1}(0)) = \ker d_p f$. Let Ω_M be the positive volume m-form of M, so that $\int_M h\Omega_M = \int_M h dM$, for any integrable function $h\colon M \to \mathbb{R}$. An equivalent expression defining α is:

$$\alpha(f, p) J_p f \Omega_M(p) = \omega(p) \wedge d_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge d_p f^k. \tag{53}$$

We conclude by applying Theorem 6.2 as follows.

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega|_Z\right\} &= \mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \alpha(X, p) dZ(p)\right\} \\
&= \int_M \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X, p) J_p X \mid X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0) \Omega_M(p) \\
&= \int_M \mathbb{E}\left\{\omega \wedge dX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge dX^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0) \\
&= \int_M \omega \wedge e_X.
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore, both sides of Equation (51) take the same value in $\mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty, -\infty, \infty - \infty\}$. Since the right hand side is the integral of a compactly supported continuous m-form by Theorem 7.6, we conclude that both sides are in $\mathbb{R}$ and thus that the random variable $\int_Z \omega|_Z$ is integrable. □

Together, Theorem 7.1 and Theorem 7.7 form the statement of Theorem A, whose proof is thus now complete.

7.4. **What does the Zonoid section know?** We have seen two cases of the Alpha formula (Theorem 6.2) where the density δ_X^α was a function of the zonoid section ζ_X.

We can ask what are the conditions on the function α for this to be the case.

Proposition 7.8. *Let $\alpha : C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ be a measurable function that is given for every $(f, p) \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \times M$ by 0 if $J_p\varphi = 0$ and else by:*

$$\alpha(f, p) = (J_p f)^{-1} T\left(\mathrm{d}_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p f^k\right) + (J_p f)^{-1} F\left(\mathrm{d}_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p f^k\right) \tag{54}$$

where $T : \Lambda^k T^*M \to \mathbb{R}$ is linear on the fibers and $F : \Lambda^k T^*M \to \mathbb{R}$ is positively homogeneous on the fibers. Then for every z-KROK *field $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and every $p \in M$, the density $\delta_X^\alpha(p)$ is a function of the zonoid $\zeta_X(p)$.*

Proof. Let $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be *z-KROK* and let $p \in M$. By definition, see (36), the density is given by

$$\begin{aligned}
\delta_X^\alpha(p) = \rho_{X(p)}(0)\, \mathbb{E}\left[T\left(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right) \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right] \\
+ \rho_{X(p)}(0)\, \mathbb{E}\left[F\left(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right) \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right].
\end{aligned}$$

The first summand gives

$$\begin{aligned}
&\rho_{X(p)}(0)\mathbb{E}\left[T\left(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right) \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right] \\
&\qquad = T\left(\rho_{X(p)}(0)\mathbb{E}\left[\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right]\right) \\
&\qquad = T(e_X(p)).
\end{aligned} \tag{55}$$

For the second term, if we call $Y := \rho_{X(p)}(0)(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k | X(p) = 0)$ then we have tautologically

$$\rho_{X(p)}(0)\mathbb{E}\left[F\left(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k\right) \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right] = \mathbb{E}\left[F(Y)\right]$$

But since F is positively homogeneous, by Theorem 3.8, this does not depend on the random vector Y but this is a function of the zonoid $\mathbb{E}\underline{Y} = \overline{\zeta_X(p)}$ which is the centered version of $\zeta_X(p)$ (see Theorem 3.3) and this concludes the proof of Proposition 7.8. □

Remark 7.9. In particular, the above proof shows that if $F \equiv 0$, then $\delta^\alpha = T(e(\zeta_X))$, while if $T \equiv 0$, then δ^α depends on $\zeta_X(p)$ only up to translations, i.e., on $\underline{\zeta_X(p)}$ (see Theorem 3.3).

In the case of the density of expected volume (Theorem 7.1) we have that $T \equiv 0$ and $F = \|\cdot\|$ is the norm (given by the Riemannian structure).

In the case of the expected current (Theorem 7.7) we see from (53) that α is given pointwise by a linear function evaluated on $(J_p f)^{-1}(\mathrm{d}_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p f^k)$. Since $J_p f = \|\mathrm{d}_p f^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p f^k\|$, the latter is a unit simple vector. Let us consider the bundle $G_+(k, T^*M) \to M$ whose fiber over $p \in M$ is the Grassmannian of oriented k-dimensional vector subspaces of T_p^*M. The set of unit simple vector in $\Lambda^k T^*M$ is identified with $G_+(k, T^*M)$ via the Plücker embedding:

$$\Pi\colon G_+\left(k, T_p^*M\right) \xrightarrow{\sim} \left\{v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \in \Lambda^k T_p^*M \;\middle|\; \|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\| = 1\right\},$$
$$(V, [v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k]) \mapsto \frac{v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k}{\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\|}$$

where $[v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k]$ denotes the orientation of V induced by the basis $v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k$. We recall that, by Theorem 3.23(iii), we have that a centered Grassmannian zonoid K in $\Lambda^k T_p^*M$ is associated, via a one to one correspondence, with a positive measure μ_K on $G(k, T_pM)$, given by (19).

Let us call *linear* those functions $\theta_T : G_+(k, T^*M) \to \mathbb{R}$ such that if $v_1, \ldots, v_k$ is an orthonormal basis of $V \subset T_p^*M$ then

$$\theta_T(V, [v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k]) = T(v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k)$$

for some linear function $T : \Lambda^k T^*M \to \mathbb{R}$. Then, we can rewrite Theorem 7.8 in the following way.

Proposition 7.10. *Let $\theta_T : G_+(k, T^*M) \to \mathbb{R}$ be a linear function and let $F : G(k, TM) \to \mathbb{R}$ be measurable. Then for every* z-KROK *random field $X : M \to \mathbb{R}^k$, we have*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \theta_T\left(N_pZ, \left[\mathrm{d}_pX^1, \ldots, \mathrm{d}_pX^k\right]\right) + F(N_pZ)\, dZ\right\} = \int_M \left(T(e(\zeta_X)) + \delta^F\right) dM, \tag{56}$$

where $\delta^F : M \to \mathbb{R}$ is a function whose value at any $p \in M$ depends only on F and on $K := \underline{\zeta_X(p)}$, and is given by

$$\delta^F(p) = \int_{G(k, T_pM)} F d\mu_K. \tag{57}$$

Proof. The only thing that does not directly derive from Theorem 7.8 is the formula (57) for δ^F. By Theorem 6.2, δ^F is given by

$$\delta^F(p) = \rho_{X(p)}(0)\, \mathbb{E}\left[F\left(\mathrm{d}_pX^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_pX^k\right) \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right],$$

where we still denote by F the even and homogeneous extension to the cone of simple vectors in $\Lambda^k TM$. (57) now follows from (25). □

7.4.1. *The zonoid section as a varifold.* Let $\Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k T^*M))$ denote the subspace of the space of zonoid sections $\Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^*M))$, as defined in § 3.7, consisting of centered ones. For instance, the centered zonoid section $\underline{\zeta_X}$ of a *z-KROK* field $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is an element of $\Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k T^*M))$.

Let $\zeta \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k T^*M))$. Following the discussion preceding Theorem 7.10, for every $p \in M$, the centered zonoid $\zeta(p)$ has an associated measure $\mu_{\zeta(p)}$ on the Grassmannian $G(k, T_p^*M)$, which we identify with $G(m-k, T_pM)$. Recall that $h_K\colon \Lambda^k T_pM \to \mathbb{R}$ denotes the support function of the zonoid $K \subset \Lambda^k T_p^*M$, in particular, $h_{[0, v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k]}(x) = |\langle x, v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\rangle|$, for $v_1, \ldots, v_n \in T_pM$ and $x \in \Lambda^k T_pM$. Because of Theorem 3.23(iii), the measure $\mu_{\zeta(p)}$ is defined as the unique measure on $G(m-k, T_pM)$ such that:

$$\begin{aligned} h_{\zeta(p)}(x) &= \int_{G(m-k, T_pM)} h_{[0, v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k]}(x) d\mu_{\zeta(p)}(V) \\ &= \int_{G(m-k, T_pM)} \|v_{k+1} \wedge \cdots \wedge v_m \wedge x\| d\mu_{\zeta(p)}(V), \quad \text{for all } x \in \Lambda^k T_pM, \end{aligned}$$

where for any V, we have chosen an orthonormal basis $v_1, \ldots, v_m$ of T_pM such that $v_1, \ldots, v_k$ is a basis of $V^\perp$. Let $d = m - k$. We can put together such family of measures, to define a *d-varifold* on M, that is, a positive measure on the total space of the Grassmann bundle $G(d, TM)$, see [2].

Definition 7.11. Let $\zeta \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k T^*M))$ and let $d = m - k$. We define the d-varifold V_ζ as the positive measure on $G(d, TM)$ such that

$$V_\zeta(A) := \int_M \mu_{\zeta(p)} \left(A \cap G\left(d, T_pM\right)\right) dM(p). \tag{58}$$

Notice that the underlying measure on M, usually denoted $\|V_\zeta\|$ in varifold theory (see [2]), is absolutely continuous with density $\ell(\zeta)$, see Theorem 3.12. And that, since ζ is continuous, V_ζ is always a Radon measure.

Lemma 7.12. *The function $\zeta \mapsto V_\zeta$, defined for all $\zeta \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}_0(\Lambda^k T^*M))$, is injective.*

Proof. (58) determines $\mu_{\zeta(p)}$, and thus $\zeta(p)$, for almost every $p \in M$; by the continuity of the latter, this determines ζ. □

There exists another natural way of constructing a d-varifold. Let $Z \subset M$ be $\mathcal{C}^1$ submanifold of dimension d, then $TZ \subset G(d, TM)$ is a subset of the Grassmann bundle[8]

Definition 7.13. Let $Z \subset M$ be $\mathcal{C}^1$ submanifold of dimension d. We define the d-varifold V_Z as the positive measure on $G(d, TM)$, supported on TZ, such that

$$V_Z(A) := \int_M 1_A(T_pZ) dM(p).$$

The reason why we talk about varifolds is that they are the proper language to understand Theorem E and also the title of the paper. Indeed, we have the following theorem.

Theorem F. Let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be a *z-KROK* random field, and let $d = m - k$ be the dimension of the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Then

$$\mathbb{E} V_Z = V_{\zeta_X}$$

Proof. Let $F\colon G(d, TM) \cong G(k, TM) \to \mathbb{R}$ be a bounded continuous function. Then Theorem 7.10 yields the thesis as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\left\{V_Z(F)\right\} &= \mathbb{E}\left\{\int_M F(T_pZ) dM(p)\right\} \\
&= \int_M \delta^F(p) dM(p) \\
&= \int_M \int_{G(d, T_pM)} F d\mu_{\zeta(p)} dM(p) = V_\zeta(F)
\end{aligned}$$ □

7.4.2. *The zonoid section does not know the random field.* The previous observations, combined with Theorem 7.10, yields that the zonoid section depends only on the law of the zero set $X^{-1}(0)$. In more technical terms, we have the following.

Proposition 7.14. *Let $X_1, X_2 \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be* z-KROK *random fields and let $Z_i = X_i^{-1}(0)$, for $i = 1, 2$. Assume that*

$$\mathbb{P}\left\{Z_1 \in W\right\} = \mathbb{P}\left\{Z_2 \in W\right\} \tag{59}$$

for any family W of submanifolds of M such that the set $\left\{f \in \Omega : f^{-1}(0) \in W\right\}$ is Borel in $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$, where $\Omega \subset \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is the subset of functions for which 0 is a regular value[9]*. Then $\underline{\zeta_{X_1}} = \underline{\zeta_{X_2}}$.*

Proof. Since X_1 and X_2 satisfy *z-KROK* (2), we consider them as rand²m elements of Ω. For a family W of submanifolds of M, we write $A_W := \{f \in \Omega : f^{-1}(0) \in W\} \subset \Omega$. Let $\mathcal{A}$ be the σ-algebra on Ω consisting of all Borel subsets of the form A_W. By definition, $\mathcal{A}$ is contained in the Borel σ-algebra of Ω and a Borel function is measurable for $\mathcal{A}$ if and only if it depends only on the zero set. In particular, for any $F\colon G(k, TM) \to \mathbb{R}$ measurable, the function $I_F : f \mapsto \int_{f^{-1}(0)} F$ is measurable with respect to $\mathcal{A}$.

Let us now consider the probability measure $\mathbb{P}_1$, respectively $\mathbb{P}_2$, on the measurable space $(\Omega, \mathcal{A})$ obtained by restricting the laws of X_1, respectively X_2, to the σ-algebra $\mathcal{A}$, respectively. By hypothesis we have that $\mathbb{P}_1 = \mathbb{P}_2$. Therefore

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{I_F(X_1)\right\} = \mathbb{E}_1\left\{I_F\right\} = \mathbb{E}_2\left\{I_F\right\} = \mathbb{E}\left\{I_F(X_2)\right\}. \tag{60}$$

where $\mathbb{E}_i$ denotes the integral with respect to the measure $\mathbb{P}_i$, for $i = 1, 2$. Theorem 7.10 implies that if (60) holds for every F, then $\mu_{X_1} = \mu_{X_2}$ and hence $\underline{\zeta_{X_1}(p)} = \underline{\zeta_{X_2}(p)}$, which is what we wanted. □

[8] If Z is of class $\mathcal{C}^2$, then $TZ \subset G(d, TM)$ is a $\mathcal{C}^1$ submanifold of dimension d.

[9] If M is compact, Ω is open. In general, it can be expressed as a countable intersection of open and dense sets, thus it is always a Borel set, see [33].

The nigiro $e(\zeta_X)$ of the zonoid section does not depend only on the law of the random submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0)$, but also on the orientation of its normal bundle NZ induced by the isomorphism given by $d_pX : N_pZ \to \mathbb{R}^k$, for all $p \in Z$.

A pair (Z, o), where Z is a submanifold (of M) and o is an orientation of NZ is called a *cooriented* submanifold (of M). By considering also the case $F = 0$ in Theorem 7.10 and reasoning as in the proof of Theorem 7.14 above, we get the following.

Proposition 7.15. *Let $X_1, X_2 \in \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be* z-KROK *random fields and let $Z_i = X_i^{-1}(0)$, for $i = 1, 2$. Let us denote by o_{X_i} the orientation of NZ_i induced by dX_i, for $i = 1, 2$. Assume that*

$$\mathbb{P}\{(Z_1, o_{X_1}) \in W\} = \mathbb{P}\{(Z_2, o_{X_2}) \in W\} \tag{61}$$

for any family W of cooriented submanifolds of M such that the set $\{f \in \Omega : (f^{-1}(0), o_f) \in W\}$ is Borel in $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$. Then $\zeta_{X_1} = \zeta_{X_2}$.

8. Vector bundles

The results of the previous section can be extended to the setting of random sections of vector bundles.

Definition 8.1. Let $\pi : E \to M$ be a smooth vector bundles of rank k and let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M|E)$ be a random section. We say that X is *locally* z-KROK if for every point $p \in M$ there is an open set $p \in U \subset M$ and a trivialization $E|_U \cong U \times \mathbb{R}^k$ such that the local random field $X|_U \in \mathcal{C}^1(U, \mathbb{R}^k)$ is *z-KROK*.

We denote the zero section of the vector bundle $E \to M$ by $0_M \subset E$. By applying Theorem 6.2 locally we get the following.

Theorem 8.2 (Alpha Formula for vector bundles)**.** *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M, g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $E \to M$ be a $\mathcal{C}^1$ real vector bundle of rank k, endowed with a metric. Let ∇ be any connection on E. Let $X \colon M \overset{\Omega}{\to} E$ be a locally* z-KROK *random section and define the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0_M)$. Let $\alpha \colon \mathcal{C}^1(M|E) \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ be a Borel measurable function. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \alpha(X, p) dZ(p)\right\} = \int_M \delta_X^\alpha(p) dM(p). \tag{62}$$

Where

$$\delta_X^\alpha(p) = \mathbb{E}\left\{\alpha(X, p) \left\| \frac{(\nabla X)_p^{\wedge k}}{k!} \right\| \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0), \tag{63}$$

and where both sides of (62) *and $\delta_X^\alpha(p)$ take values in $\mathbb{R} \cup \{+\infty, -\infty, \infty - \infty\}$.*

Remark 8.3. The value of $(\nabla X)_p$ at a point p such that $X(p) = 0$ doesn't depend on the choice of the connection (see also Theorem 4.5). It is a linear map $(\nabla X)_p \colon T_pM \to E_p$ between two Euclidean spaces, thus it has a well defined Jacobian determinant $J(\nabla X)_p =: J_pX$, which we wrote in a more fancy way, using the language of double forms, for which we refer to [4]. This language defines the linear map $(\nabla X)_p^{\wedge k} \colon \Lambda^k T_pM \to \Lambda^k E_p =: \det E_p$, such that

$$v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \mapsto k! \nabla X_p(v_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \nabla X_p(v_k), \tag{64}$$

where the codomain can be identified as $\Lambda^k E_p = e_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge e_k \mathbb{R}$, for an orthonormal basis $e_1, \ldots, e_k$ of E_p. We interpret $(\nabla X)_p^{\wedge k}$ as an element of $\Lambda^k T_p^* M \otimes \det E$. Thus, choosing $v_1, \ldots, v_k$ to be a orthonormal basis of $(\ker(\nabla X)_p)^\perp$ we have the equality:

$$\left\| \frac{(\nabla X)_p^{\wedge k}}{k!} \right\| = \left| \det\left(\langle (\nabla X)_p(v_i), e_j \rangle \right)_{1 \leq i, j \leq k} \right| = J_pX. \tag{65}$$

Remark 8.4. The function $\rho_{X(p)} \colon E_p \to [0, +\infty)$ is the density of $[X(p)]$ with respect to the Euclidean metric on the fiber E_p. This term depends on the choice of the metric as well as the Jacobian of X (see (65)), but the product of the two does not, so that δ_X^α is independent on the choice of a metric on E.

Theorem 5.1 can be extended to define the *zonoid section* in this setting.

Definition 8.5. Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M, g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $E \to M$ be a $\mathcal{C}^1$ real vector bundle of rank k, endowed with a metric. Let $X \in \mathcal{C}^1(M|E)$ be locally z-KRoK. The associated *zonoid section* $\zeta_X \in \Gamma(\mathscr{Z}(\Lambda^k T^* M \otimes \det E))$ is defined for every $p \in M$ by

$$\zeta_X(p) := \mathbb{E}\left\{ \left[0, \frac{(\nabla X)_p^{\wedge k}}{k!}\right] \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0 \right\} \rho_{X(p)}(0).$$

We recall that an orientation of E corresponds to a trivialization of $\det E$. In general, the support function of ζ_X is a continuous function $h_{\zeta_X} : \Lambda^k TM \otimes \det E^* \to \mathbb{R}$ and the nigiro $e_X = e(\zeta_X)$ is a continuous section of $\Lambda^k T^*M \otimes \det E$. Moreover, we compute the length $\ell(\zeta_X)$ and the other intrinsic volumes of ζ_X in terms of the metric on $\Lambda^k T^*M \otimes \det E$ induced by the Riemannian metric and the metric on E, hence they define continuous functions on M.

By applying locally the results of § 7 we extend them to the setting of vector bundles. In particular, Theorem 5.2, Theorem B, Theorem C, Theorem 7.1, Theorem 7.6, Theorem 7.7 hold with the obvious modifications of the statements.

Theorem 8.6. *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let (M, g) be a Riemannian manifold of dimension m. Let $E \to M$ be a $\mathcal{C}^1$ real vector bundle of rank k, endowed with a metric h. Let $X \colon M \xrightarrow{\Omega} E$ be a locally* z-KROK *random section and define the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0_M)$.*

(1) (Pull-back property) *Let $\varphi \colon S \to M$ be a $\mathcal{C}^1$ map such that $\varphi \pitchfork Z$ almost surely. Then $X \circ \varphi$ is a locally* z-KROK *random section of the pull-back bundle $\varphi^* E \to S$ and*

$$\zeta_{X\circ\varphi}(p) = (d_p\varphi^* \otimes \mathrm{id}_{\det E})\, \zeta_X(p).$$

(2) *If X_1, X_2 are independent locally* z-KROK *random sections of two vector bundles E_1, E_2 over M, then $Z_1 \cap Z_2$ is the zero set of $X_1 \oplus X_2 \colon M \xrightarrow{\Omega} E_1 \oplus E_2$, and there is a canonical identification $\det(E_1 \oplus E_2) = \det E_1 \otimes \det E_2$. If $X_1 \oplus X_2 \pitchfork 0_M$ almost surely, then $X_1 \oplus X_2$ is* z-KROK *and*

$$\zeta_{X_1\oplus X_2} = \zeta_{X_1} \wedge \zeta_{X_2},$$

where this wedge operation is meant as a bilinear map $\Lambda^{k_1} T^*M \otimes \det E_1 \times \Lambda^{k_2} T^*M \otimes \det E_2 \to \Lambda^{k_1+k_2} T^*M \otimes \det E_1 \otimes \det E_2$.

(3) *For any Borel $A \subset M$ Borel set, we have*

$$\mathbb{E}\{\mathrm{vol}_{m-k}(Z \cap A)\} = \int_A \ell(\zeta_X) dM.$$

(4) *If E and M are oriented, then we identify $\det E = \mathbb{R}$ and Z is oriented according to Theorem 7.5, then we have the equality of currents:*

$$\mathbb{E} \int_Z = \int_M \wedge e_X \in \Omega_c^{(m-k)}(M)^*.$$

Theorem 8.7. *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 8.6 and assuming that E and M are oriented, if moreover e_X is smooth, then it is closed and the class $[e_X] \in H^k_{DR}(M)$ is the (De Rham) Euler class of the vector bundle E.*

Proof. Observe that $d \int_Z = 0$ in the sense of currents, that is, $\int_Z \omega = 0$ for every ω closed. By linearity, the same holds for the current $\mathbb{E} \int_Z$. If e_X is smooth, point (4) above implies that then $de_X = 0$. Let $\eta \in \Omega^k(M)$ be a De Rham representative of the Euler class of E. It is proved in [19, Chapter 12] that if ω is a closed form, then $\int_Z \omega|_Z = \int_M \omega \wedge \eta$ holds for all $X \pitchfork 0_M$. By taking the expectation on both sides and using point (4) we obtain the identity:

$$Q([\omega], [\eta]) = \int_M \omega \wedge \eta = \int_M \omega \wedge e_X = Q([\omega], [e_X]), \quad \forall\, [\omega] \in H^{(m-k)}_{DR}(M)$$

where Q denotes the (De Rham) intersection form of M. Since the latter is nondegenerate by Poincaré duality (see [19, Chapter 3]) it follows that $[\eta] = [e_X]$. □

The latter statement can be expressed in a more general form using the language of twisted forms. Given a real line bundle $L \to M$, a *i-form with values in L* is a section of $\Lambda^i T^*M \otimes L \to M$ and the space of such objects is denoted as $\Omega^i(M, L)$. When L is the orientation bundle of the manifold, that we will denote as L_M, the elements of $\Omega^m(M, L_M)$ are called *densities* and there is a canonical integration operator $\int_M \colon \Omega^m_c(M, L_M) \to \mathbb{R}$, see [19, Chapter 7] or [74, Appendix A]. Given $e \in \Omega^k(M, \det E)$ and $\omega \in \Omega^{(m-k)}(M, L_M \otimes \det E^*)$, their product $\omega \wedge e$ can be canonically identified as a density, since $L_M \otimes \det E^* \otimes \det E \cong L_M$ and therefore the number $\int_M \omega \wedge e$ is well defined, regardless of orientability.

On the other hand, once the vector bundle E is endowed with a metric, if $X \pitchfork 0_M$ then the orientation line bundle L_Z of the submanifold $Z = X^{-1}(0_M)$ is isomorphic to $L_Z \cong L_M \otimes \det E|_Z$ (the isomorphism depends on the euclidean structure of $\det E$). Therefore, given $\omega \in \Omega^{(m-k)}(M, L_M \otimes \det E^*)$, its restriction $\omega|_Z$ can be seen as a density on Z and thus the integral $\int_Z \omega|_Z$ is well defined.

Corollary 8.8. *Let $k \leq m \in \mathbb{N}$. Let M be a smooth manifold of dimension m. Let $E \to M$ be a smooth real vector bundle of rank k, endowed with a metric. Let $X\colon M \overset{\Omega}{\hookrightarrow} E$ be a locally* z-KROK *random section and define the random submanifold $Z := X^{-1}(0_M)$. Let $\omega \in \Omega_c^{(m-k)}(M, L_M \otimes \det E^*)$. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{\int_Z \omega|_Z\right\} = \int_M \omega \wedge e_X.$$

Remark 8.9. The language of twisted forms allows to define a twisted version of De Rham cohomology, see [19]. In this sense, it is easy to see that again we have that $de_X = 0$ and $[e_X] \in H^k_{dR}(M, \det E)$ is the Euler class of the vector bundle E.

9. Crofton formula in Finsler manifolds

A *Finsler structure* on a manifold M is the choice of a norm F_p on each tangent space T_pM that depends continuously on the point $p \in M$. This gives a well defined notion of length of curves. Indeed, given $\gamma : [0,1] \to M$ a smooth curve, one defines

$$\ell^F(\gamma) := \int_0^1 F_{\gamma(t)}(\dot\gamma(t))\mathrm{d}t. \tag{66}$$

The choice of a full dimensional convex body in each cotangent space induces a norm in the tangent space. Indeed, if $\zeta(p) \subset T_p^*M$ is a symmetric convex body containing the origin in its interior, then the support function $h_{\zeta(p)} : T_pM \to \mathbb{R}$ defines a norm. In our case, the (centered) zonoid section of a *z-KROK* scalar field is not always full dimensional and defines only a semi norm.

Definition 9.1. We call a *semi Finsler structure* on M, the choice of a semi norm $F_p : T_pM \to \mathbb{R}$ for each $p \in M$ depending continuously on p. Equivalently, this is the choice of a continuous section $p \mapsto \zeta(p) \subset T_p^*M$ of centrally symmetric convex bodies containing the origin.

Remark 9.2. A centrally symmetric convex body $\zeta(p) \subset T_p^*M$ is contained in a hyperplane $v^\perp$ with $v \in T_pM$ if and only if $h_{\zeta(p)}(v) = 0$. For the semi Finsler structure, it means that traveling from p along the direction v is *free* and curves that pass at p tangent to v have locally length zero.

The zonoid section associated to a *z-KROK* scalar field (see Theorem 5.1) provides then a semi Finsler structure.

Definition 9.3. Let $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be a *z-KROK* field. We denote by F^X the semi Finsler structure induced by $\underline{\zeta_X}(\cdot)$, where recall that $\underline{\zeta_X}(\cdot)$ is the centered zonoid of $\zeta_X(\cdot)$, i.e., for all $p \in M$ and all $v \in T_pM$

$$F_p^X(v) := \frac{\rho_{X(p)}(0)}{2}\mathbb{E}\left\{|\mathrm{d}_pX(v)| \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right\}. \tag{67}$$

Our previous results interpret in this context as follows.

Proposition 9.4 (Crofton formula for curves)**.** *Let $X \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be* z-KROK *and let $Z := X^{-1}(0)$. Let $\gamma : [0,1] \to M$ be a smooth curve such that $\gamma \pitchfork Z$ almost surely. Then*

$$\mathbb{E}\#(\gamma \cap Z) = 2\,\ell^{F^X}(\gamma). \tag{68}$$

Proof. Consider the random field $X \circ \gamma : [0,1] \to \mathbb{R}$ and apply the pull-back property Theorem B. By (29), we have

$$h_{\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)}(\partial_t) = h_{\zeta_X(\gamma(t))}(\dot\gamma(t)) \tag{69}$$

Since $\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)$ lives in a space of dimension 1 (formally the tangent to $[0,1]$), its length is given by

$$\begin{aligned}\ell(\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)) &= h_{\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)}(\partial_t) + h_{\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)}(-\partial_t)\\ &= h_{\zeta_X(\gamma(t))}(\dot\gamma(t)) + h_{\zeta_X(\gamma(t))}(-\dot\gamma(t))\\ &= 2h_{\underline{\zeta_X(\gamma(t))}}(\dot\gamma(t)) = 2F^X(\dot\gamma(t)).\end{aligned}$$

Applying Theorem 7.1, we obtain

$$\mathbb{E}\#(X\circ\gamma)^{-1}(0) = \int_0^1 \ell\left(\zeta_{X\circ\gamma}(t)\right)\,\mathrm{d}t = 2\int_0^1 F^X(\dot\gamma(t))\,\mathrm{d}t$$

We recognize on the right $2\ell^{F^X}(\gamma)$. To conclude, note that $(X\circ\gamma)^{-1}(0) = \gamma^{-1}(\gamma \cap Z)$ and thus $\#(X \circ \gamma)^{-1}(0) = \#(\gamma \cap Z)$. □

Formulas of the type of (68) are called *Crofton formula* from the original Crofton formula with curves on the sphere and random hyperplanes.

Constructions of Finsler structures that admit a Crofton formula are known for random hyperplanes in projective space, see [10, 64, 67]. Moreover, a more general result very similar to Theorem 9.4 can be found in [84, Theorem A], although the *z-KROK* hypothesis is significantly more general and the construction of the metric F^X explicit with (67).

Remark 9.5. Note that the (semi) Finsler structure satisfying (68) is unique. Indeed, if $v \in T_pM$ is such that there exists a curve $\gamma : [0,1] \to M$ almost surely transversal to Z, such that $\gamma(0) = p$ and $\dot\gamma(0) = v$, then, by (66), we have $\frac{1}{\varepsilon}\ell^{F^X}(\gamma|_{[0,\varepsilon]}) \to F^X(v)$ as $\varepsilon \to 0$. Moreover, by Theorem 9.6 below, almost all $(p,v) \in TM$ admit such a curve.

Let (M,g) be a Riemannian manifold. For any $(p,v) \in TM$, let $r(p) \in (0,+\infty)$ denote the injective radius of p and let $\gamma_{p,v}\colon (-\varepsilon(p,v), \varepsilon(p,v)) \to M$ be the curve defined as

$$\gamma_{p,v}(t) := \exp_p(tv), \quad \forall\, |t| < \varepsilon(p,v) := \frac{r(p)}{\|v\|}.$$

Lemma 9.6. *Let $X \Subset \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R})$ be* z-KROK *and $Z = X^{-1}(0)$. Then for almost every $(p,v) \in TM$ we have that $\mathbb{P}\{\gamma_{p,v} \pitchfork Z\} = 1$.*

Proof. In fact, we are only going to use the assumption that 0 is a regular value of X almost surely. Consider the open set $\mathcal{U} \subset TM \times \mathbb{R}$ of triples (p,v,t) such that $|t| < \varepsilon(p,v)$. By construction $\mathcal{U}$ is an open set and the function

$$\phi\colon \mathcal{U} \to M, \quad \phi(p,v,t) = \gamma_{p,v}(t)$$

is a smooth submersion, since the exponential map $\exp_p$ is a local diffeomorphism on the ball $\{v \in T_pM\colon \|v\| < r(p)\}$. Then, $\phi \pitchfork S$ for any $\mathcal{C}^r$ hypersurface $S \subset M$, so that, by the *parametric transversality theorem* [33, Theorem 2.7], we have that $\gamma_{p,v} \pitchfork S$ for almost every $(p,v) \in TM$. The theorem can be applied whenever

$$r > \max\{0, \dim\mathbb{R} - (\dim M - \dim S)\} = 0,$$

thus, in particular, for $S = Z$ of class $\mathcal{C}^1$, as in the hypotheses. Therefore, we have

$$\mathbb{P}\left\{\gamma_{(p,v)} \pitchfork Z \text{ for a.e. } (p,v) \in TM\right\} = 1. \tag{70}$$

Let us consider the set:

$$A := \left\{((p,v), f) \in TM \times \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R})\colon \gamma_{p,v} \not\pitchfork f^{-1}(0)\right\}.$$

We need to show that $\mathbb{P}\{((p,v),X) \in A\} = 0$ for almost every $(p,v) \in TM$. By Tonelli's theorem, since A is measurable, this is equivalent to show that A has measure zero and this can be proven by sectioning in the opposite way (i.e., exchanging the order of integration). For each $f \in \mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R})$ such that $f \pitchfork \{0\}$, we have by Equation (70) that $A_f := \{(p,v) \in TM |\, ((p,v),f) \in A\}$ has measure zero for $[X]$-almost every f, hence A_f has measure zero, which by Tonelli implies that A has measure zero. □

Unlike for the length, there are several definitions of volume in Finsler manifolds. One way to define k-dimensional volumes of submanifolds is to define a k-density, that is, a nonnegative homogeneous function φ_k on the simple vectors of $\Lambda^k TM$. The k-densities satisfy a pull-back property and thus, given an embedded submanifold $\iota : S \hookrightarrow M$, $\iota^*\varphi_k$ defines a density (in the classical sense) and can be integrated. The k-volume of S is then defined to be

$$\mathrm{vol}_{\varphi_k}(S) := \int_S \iota^*\varphi_k.$$

See [85] for the possible choices of k-densities and more details. One of the most common choices is the *Holmes-Thompson density*. To define it, it is convenient for us to fix a Riemannian metric on our manifold M.

Definition 9.7. Let F be a semi Finsler structure on M and let $\zeta(p) \subset T_p^*M$ be the convex body such that $F_p = h_{\zeta(p)}$. The kth *Holmes–Thompson* density φ_k^{HT} is given for all $p \in M$, and all simple vectors $v = v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k \in \Lambda^k T_pM$

$$\varphi_k^{HT}(v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k) := \frac{\|v_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_k\|}{b_k}\, \mathrm{vol}_k(\pi_v(\zeta(p)))$$

where $\|\cdot\|$ is the norm on $\Lambda^k T_pM$ induced by the Riemannian structure, π_v is the orthogonal projection onto $Span(v_1, \ldots, v_k)$ (identifying the space and its dual) and vol_k is the k-dimensional volume in the Riemannian structure in T_pM.

The reader can refer to [85, p. 19]. One can also show that this definition doesn't depend on the choice of the Riemannian metric, however, in our case, this becomes clear with the next lemma.

Lemma 9.8. *Let F be a semi Finsler structure on M such that for each $p \in M$, there is a zonoid $\zeta(p) \in \mathscr{Z}_0(T_p^*M)$ such that $F_p = h_{\zeta(p)}$. Then, the Holmes–Thompson density is given by*

$$\varphi_k^{HT} = \frac{2}{k!b_k} h_{\zeta(p)^{\wedge k}}.$$

Proof. This is a consequence of the definition and Theorem 3.18. □

Now with a proof very similar to the proof of Theorem 9.4 we obtain a Crofton formula for higher dimensional volumes.

Theorem 9.9 (Crofton formula)**.** *Let $1 \leq k \leq m$, let $X_1, \dots, X_k \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be i.i.d. multi-transverse* z-KROK *fields and let $Z^{(k)} := (X_1)^{-1}(0) \cap \cdots \cap (X_k)^{-1}(0)$. Let $\iota : S \hookrightarrow M$ be an embedded submanifold of dimension k such that $S \pitchfork Z^{(k)}$ almost surely, then we have*

$$\mathbb{E}\#\left(S \cap Z^{(k)}\right) = k!b_k \operatorname{vol}_k^{F^{X_1}}(S)$$

where $\operatorname{vol}_k^{F^{X_1}}$ denotes the Holmes–Thompson volume for the semi Finsler structure defined by Equation (67)*.*

Proof. The proof is almost identical to the proof of Theorem 9.4 but let us repeat it, if only to compute the constant. Let $X^{(k)} := (X_1, \dots, X_k) \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and consider $X^{(k)} \circ \iota \in C^1(S, \mathbb{R}^k)$. Since S is almost surely transversal to $Z^{(k)} = (X^{(k)})^{-1}(0)$, by the pull-back property (Theorem B) it is *z-KROK* and we have for all $q \in S$

$$\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q) = \mathrm{d}_q \iota^* \zeta_{X^{(k)}}(\iota(q)) = \mathrm{d}_q \iota^* \left((\zeta_{X_1}(\iota(q)))^{\wedge k}\right) = \left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota^* \zeta_{X_1}(\iota(q))\right)^{\wedge k}.$$

where the second equality holds because $X^{(k)} := (X_1, \dots, X_k)$ and $X_1, \dots, X_k$ are i.i.d. and the third equality is by definition of the linear maps induced in the exterior algebra. We fix a Riemannian structure on S such that ι is a Riemannian embedding and we let $\omega_q \in \Lambda^k T^q S$ be the choice of a volume form (if S is not orientable we can work locally). Now we note that $\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q)$ lives in the one dimensional space $\Lambda^k T_q S$ thus its length is given by:

$$\begin{aligned}
\ell\left(\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q)\right) &= h_{\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q)}(\omega_q) + h_{\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q)}(-\omega_q) \\
&= h_{\zeta_{X^{(k)}}(\iota(q))}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(\omega_q)\right) + h_{\zeta_{X^{(k)}}(\iota(q))}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(-\omega_q)\right) \\
&= 2h_{\underline{\zeta_{X^{(k)}}}(\iota(q))}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(\omega_q)\right) \\
&= 2h_{\underline{\zeta_{X_1}}(\iota(q))^{\wedge k}}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(\omega_q)\right) = k!b_k \varphi_k^{HT}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(\omega_q)\right).
\end{aligned}$$

Where here φ_k^{HT} denotes the Holmes Thompson density for the semi Finsler structure defined by $\underline{\zeta_{X_1}}$. To conclude, we note that $\#(X^{(k)} \circ \iota)^{-1}(0) = \#(S \cap Z^{(k)})$ and thus applying Theorem 7.3 to the *z-KROK* field $(X^{(k)} \circ \iota)$ we get

$$\mathbb{E}\#\left(S \cap X^{(k)}\right) = \int_S \ell\left(\zeta_{X^{(k)} \circ \iota}(q)\right) \mathrm{d}S(q) = k!b_k \int_S \varphi_k^{HT}\left(\mathrm{d}_q \iota(\omega_q)\right) \mathrm{d}S(q)$$

which is what we wanted. □

If we consider the submanifold S in Theorem 9.9 to be again random, given by *z-KROK* fields, we obtain the following funny formula.

Corollary 9.10. *Let $X_1, \dots, X_k, Y_1, \dots, Y_{m-k} \in C^1(M, \mathbb{R})$ be independent multi-transverse* z-KROK *fields with $X_1, \dots, X_k$, respectively $Y_1, \dots, Y_{m-k}$, identically distributed. Consider $Z_X^{(k)} := (X_1)^{-1}(0) \cap \cdots \cap (X_k)^{-1}(0)$ and $Z_Y^{(m-k)} := (Y_1)^{-1}(0) \cap \cdots \cap (Y_{m-k})^{-1}(0)$. Then we have*

$$k!b_k \mathbb{E}\left[\operatorname{vol}_k^{F^X}\left(Z_Y^{(m-k)}\right)\right] = (m-k)!b_{m-k} \mathbb{E}\left[\operatorname{vol}_{m-k}^{F^Y}\left(Z_X^{(k)}\right)\right]$$

where $\operatorname{vol}_k^{F^X}$, respectively $\operatorname{vol}_{m-k}^{F^Y}$, denotes the Holmes-Thompson volume for the semi Finsler structure defined by $\underline{\zeta_{X_1}}$, respectively by $\underline{\zeta_{Y_1}}$.

Proof. Applying the previous result Theorem 9.9 successively to $X_1, \dots, X_k$, fixing $Z_Y^{(m-k)}$ and to $Y_1, \dots, Y_{m-k}$ fixing $Z_X^{(k)}$, we get, using the independence assumption, that both sides are equal to $\mathbb{E}\#(Z_X^{(k)} \cap Z_Y^{(m-k)})$. □

10. Examples

10.1. **Abundance of *z-KROK* fields.** The following result shows that *z-KROK* random fields are *dense* in the family of smooth random fields with integrable $\mathcal{C}^1$ norm.

Theorem 10.1. *Let $Y \in \mathcal{C}^q(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be a random field, with $q \geq 1 + \max\{m-k, 0\}$[10], such that $\mathbb{E}\{J_p Y\}$ is finite and continuous with respect to $p \in M$. Let $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^k$ be an independent random vector with a continuous nowhere vanishing bounded density ρ_λ. Then $X := Y - \lambda$ is* z-KROK.

Proof. Let us show the validity of the *z-KROK* hypotheses one by one.

(1) Clearly $X \in \mathcal{C}^1$.

(2) Observe that 0 is a critical value of $Y - x$ if and only if x is a critical value of Y. By Sard's theorem, the set of such points has Lebesgue measure zero and since the law of λ is absolutely continuous with respect to Lebesgue, we obtain *z-KROK* (2) by integrating first with respect to λ then with respect to Y.

(3) We can express the density of the random vector $X(p) \in \mathbb{R}^k$ as follows:

$$\rho_{X(p)}(x) = \int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \rho_\lambda(t-x) d[Y(p)](t) = \mathbb{E}\left\{\rho_\lambda\left(Y(p) - x\right)\right\}.$$

The latter expectation is taken with respect to the randomness of Y. Notice that $\rho_{X(p)}(x) > 0$ for all $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$ because ρ_λ is assumed to have the same property.

(4) The continuity of $\rho_{X(p)}(x)$ can be shown using the Dominated Convergence Theorem since ρ_λ is uniformly bounded.

(5) Let $\mathbb{1}_B$ be the characteristic function of a Borel set $B \subset \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$. For any $(p, x) \in M \times \mathbb{R}^k$ we define the probability measure

$$\mu(p,x)(B) := \frac{\mathbb{E}\left\{\mathbb{1}_B\left(Y - Y(p) + x\right)\rho_\lambda\left(Y(p) - x\right)\right\}}{\rho_{X(p)}(x)} \tag{71}$$

To see that $\mu(p,\cdot)(\cdot)$ is a regular conditional probability (see Subsection 4.1) for X given $X(p)$, let us take a Borel subset $V \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ and compute

$$\begin{aligned}
&\mathbb{P}\left\{X \in B; X(p) \in V\right\} \\
&\qquad = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \left(\int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \mathbb{1}_B(f-t)\mathbb{1}_V(f(p)-t)\rho_\lambda(t) d\mathbb{R}^k(t) \right) d[Y](f) \\
&\qquad = \int_{\mathcal{C}^1(M,\mathbb{R}^k)} \left(\int_{V} \mathbb{1}_B(f-f(p)+x)\rho_\lambda(f(p)-x) d\mathbb{R}^k(x) \right) d[Y](f) \\
&\qquad = \int_V \mathbb{E}\left\{\mathbb{1}_B\left(Y - Y(p) + x\right)\rho_\lambda\left(Y(p) - x\right)\right\} \frac{\rho_{X(p)}(x)}{\rho_{X(p)}(x)} d\mathbb{R}^k(x) \\
&\qquad = \int_V \mu(p,x)(B) d[X(p)](x).
\end{aligned}$$

Finally, we prove *z-KROK* (5) by showing point (2) of Theorem 4.6. Let α be a bounded and continuous functional on $\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ and let $(p_n, x_n) \to (p, 0)$ in $M \times \mathbb{R}^k$. Then

$$\mathbb{E}\left\{(J_{p_n} X)\alpha(X) | X(p_n) = x_n\right\} = \frac{\mathbb{E}\left\{(J_{p_n} Y)\alpha(Y - Y(p_n) + x_n)\rho_\lambda\left(Y(p_n) - x_n\right)\right\}}{\rho_{X(p_n)}(x_n)}.$$

We already proved that the denominator is continuous and never vanishing. The convergence of the numerator can be proved using the following version of the Dominated Convergence Theorem, which is a corollary of Fatou's lemma.

Lemma 10.2. *Let $0 \leq f_n \leq g_n$ be random variables such that $f_n \to f$ and $g_n \to g$ almost surely. Assume that $\mathbb{E}\{g_n\} \to \mathbb{E}\{g\}$, then $\mathbb{E}\{f_n\} \to \mathbb{E}\{f\}$.*

To conclude, we apply Theorem 10.2 with $f_n = J_{p_n} Y \alpha(Y - Y(p_n) + x_n)\rho_\lambda(Y(p_n) - x_n)$ and $g_n = (J_{p_n} Y)C$, where $C > 0$ is a constant such that $\alpha(f)\rho_\lambda(x) \leq C$ for all f and x. Here we are using the crucial hypothesis that $\mathbb{E}\{J_{p_n} Y\} \to \mathbb{E}\{J_p Y\}$. □

Remark 10.3. If we used the alternative weaker version of *z-KROK* hypotheses discussed in Theorem 5.5, the requirement that ρ_λ is nonvanishing could be dropped.

[10] This is the minimal regularity required for Sard's theorem [66] to hold.

If X is a random field obtained as in Theorem 10.1, let us say that X is *super*-z-KROK. For such fields, the transversality hypothesis in Theorem B and Theorem C are automatically satisfied, as well as the multi-transversality hypothesis in Theorem D, Theorem E, Theorem 9.9, Theorem 9.10.

Corollary 10.4. *Let $X_1 = Y_1 - \lambda_1, X_2 := Y_2 - \lambda_2$ be independent random fields on M, obtained as in Theorem 10.1. Then, (X_1, X_2) is super-*z-KROK*. Moreover, for any $S \subset M$ smooth submanifold, we have that $X_i|_S$ is super-*z-KROK *on S, for $i = 1, 2$. Furthermore, any set $X_1, \dots, X_k$ of independent super-*z-KROK *fields is multi-transverse.*

Proof. Apply Theorem 10.1 to the random field $Y_0 := (Y_1, Y_2)$ and the random vector $\lambda := (\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$ to deduce that (X_1, X_2) is *z-KROK*. Apply Theorem 10.1 to the random field $Y_S := Y_i|_S$ and the random vector λ_i to deduce that $X_i|_S$ is *z-KROK*. In both cases, the difference of the dimensions (the number corresponding to $m - k$) is smaller than that of the original field, and the regularity q is preserved, thus the hypotheses of Theorem 10.1 are satisfied. It follows, by induction, that a field X obtained as in (45) of Theorem 7.2 is super-*z-KROK*, whenever the starting set of fields $X_1, \dots, X_k$ are super-*z-KROK*, hence we conclude. □

Example 10.5. With this example, we show the necessity of the regularity requirement in Theorem 10.1. We only consider the simplest case: $m = 2$, $n = 1$, and show that the theorem is false if $q = 1$ (the statement requires $q \geq 2$). Whitney [79] showed the existence of a function $f\colon \mathbb{R}^2 \to \mathbb{R}$ of class $\mathcal{C}^1$ whose gradient vanishes identically on a connected curve $K \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ and such that $f|_K\colon K \to [0,1]$ is a homeomorphism. As a consequence, any number in $[0,1]$ is a critical value of f. Set $Y := f$ a constant random field in $\mathcal{C}^1(\mathbb{R}^2, \mathbb{R})$. Therefore, for any absolutely continuous random variable λ, having a non-vanishing bounded density ρ_λ, the field $X := Y - \lambda$ does not satisfy *z-KROK* (2), in that $X \pitchfork 0$ implies $\lambda \notin [0,1]$, which is an event of probability strictly smaller than 1.

Example 10.6. Using the same function f of Theorem 10.5, we can justify the transversality assumption in Theorem B and Theorem C. Starting with the latter, we construct $X_1 \in \mathcal{C}^1(\mathbb{R}^3, \mathbb{R})$ and $X_2 \in \mathcal{C}^\infty(\mathbb{R}^3, \mathbb{R})$, Gaussian and *z-KROK*, but such that $(0,0)$ is not a regular value for $X_0 := (X_1, X_2)$, hence X_0 is not a *z-KROK* field. Let γ_1, γ_2 be two independent normal variables and define

$$X_1(x,y,z) := z - f(x,y) + \gamma_1; \quad X_2(x,y,z) := z + \gamma_2;$$

Theorem 10.1 implies that X_2 is *z-KROK*, but we cannot apply it to X_2, since $q = 1 < 3$. To see that X_1 is *z-KROK*, we can check directly that X_1 satisfies *z-KROK*-2, by observing that $dX_1 = (-df, 1)$ never vanishes, then argue as in the proof of Theorem 10.1 for the other four conditions. We have that a point $p = (x,y,z)$ is a critical zero of X_0 if and only if p satisfies the following system of equations

$$\begin{cases} f(x,y) = \gamma_1 - \gamma_2, \\ z = -\gamma_2, \\ d_{(x,y)} f = (0,0) \end{cases}$$

For the system to have no solution p, one must have that $\gamma_1 - \gamma_2 \notin [0,1]$, which is an event of probability strictly smaller than one. Therefore, $\mathbb{P}\{X_0 \pitchfork (0,0)\} < 1$. Now for Theorem B, let us set $S = \{z = 0\}$. If we repeat the same argument with $\gamma_2 = 0$, we conclude that $\mathbb{P}\{X_1|_S \pitchfork 0\} = \mathbb{P}\{X_0 \pitchfork (0,0)\} < 1$, thus $X_1|_S$ is not *z-KROK*.

10.2. **Random level sets.** Let $\varphi \in C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be a fixed function and let $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}^k$ be a random vector whose law admits a *continuous* density $\rho_\lambda : \mathbb{R}^k \to \mathbb{R}$. Then the random field

$$X := \varphi - \lambda \in C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$$

is *z-KROK*. Indeed, this is a special case of Theorem 10.1 except for the fact that we don't need to assume nothing but the continuity of ρ_λ. So, *z-KROK* (2) follows from Sard's theorem; $X(p)$ admits the continuous density given for every $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$ by $\rho_{X(p)}(x) = \rho_\lambda(\varphi(p) - x)$ and this gives *z-KROK* (3) and *z-KROK* (4).

Finally, to prove *z-KROK* (5), we let $\mu(p,x)$ be the Dirac delta measure $\mu(p,x) = \delta_{\varphi - \varphi(p) + x}$, which corresponds to (71) in this case. Reasoning as in the proof of Theorem 10.1, one can check that this is a regular conditional probability for X given $X(p)$, but this time it is automatic to see that μ satisfies *z-KROK* (5), even if ρ_λ is not bounded or if it has zeroes.

Note that in that case, we have

$$\left(\mathrm{d}_p X^1 \wedge \dots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p X^k \,\middle|\, X(p) = 0\right) = \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^1 \wedge \dots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^k \tag{72}$$

almost surely. Thus, we obtain for all $p \in M$:

$$\zeta_X(p) = \rho_\lambda(\varphi(p)) \left[0, \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^1 \wedge \dots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^k\right].$$

In particular, notice that the zonoid is $\{0\}$ at critical points of φ and thus is $\{0\}$ everywhere if φ is constant.

In this setting, Theorem 7.1 translates into the coarea formula for the function $f(p) = J_p\varphi \cdot \rho_\lambda(\varphi(p))$, while Theorem 7.7 yields:

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^k} \rho_\lambda(t) \left(\int_{\varphi^{-1}(t)} \omega|_{\ker d\varphi} \right) d\mathbb{R}^k(t) = \int_M \rho_\lambda(\varphi(p)) \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^k \wedge \omega.$$

Moreover, in the case where $k = 1$, the semi Finsler structure defined by X (see § 9) is given for all $v \in T_pM$ by

$$F_p^X(v) = \frac{\rho_\lambda(\varphi(p))}{2} |d_p\varphi(v)|.$$

Then, if $\gamma : [0,1] \to M$ is a smooth curve that is transversal to φ, one can see that its length for this semi Finsler structure is given by $\ell^{F^X}(\gamma) = \frac{1}{2}\mathbb{P}(\lambda \in [\varphi(\gamma(0)), \varphi(\gamma(1))])$.

10.3. **Finite dimensional fields.** Let us detail the case where the random field lives in a finite dimensional subspace of $C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$. This example could help the reader to understand better the *z-KROK* conditions and the construction of the zonoid section.

Proposition 10.7. *Let $\mathcal{F} \subset C^\infty(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be a subspace of dimension $n < \infty$ endowed with a scalar product and such that for all $p \in M$, the map $ev_p : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}^k$, $\varphi \mapsto \varphi(p)$ is surjective. Let $X \in \mathcal{F}$ be a random function whose law admits a* continuous *density $\rho_X : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}$ such that $\rho_X(0) > 0$ and such that when $\|\varphi\| \to \infty$, we have $\rho_X(\varphi) = O(\|\varphi\|^{-\alpha})$ for some $\alpha > n$. Then X is* z-KROK.

Proof. Let us detail the *z-KROK* conditions one by one.

For *z-KROK* (2), the trick is to use the *parametric transversality theorem*, see [33, Theorem 2.7]. Indeed, consider the function $\Phi : \mathcal{F} \times M \to \mathbb{R}$ given by $\Phi(\varphi, p) = \varphi(p)$. Then its differential at (φ, p) is given by $ev_p \oplus \mathrm{d}_p\varphi$. By assumption this is surjective and thus the map Φ is transversal to zero, i.e. 0 is a regular value of Φ. The parametric transversality theorem then tells us that for almost all $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}$, the map $\varphi \mapsto \varphi(p)$ is transversal to 0, i.e. for almost all $\varphi \in \mathcal{F}$, 0 is a regular value of φ which is what we wanted.

The law of $X(p)$ is the push forward of the law of X by the linear map $ev_p : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}^k$. Suppose $B \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ is a Borel subset of measure 0. Then $\mathbb{P}(X(p) \in B) = \mathbb{P}(X \in ev_p^{-1}(B))$. Let us denote

$$\mathcal{F}_p := \ker(ev_p) = \{\varphi \in \mathcal{F} \,|\, \varphi(p) = 0\}.$$

Then the space $ev_p^{-1}(x)$ is an affine subspace parallel to $\mathcal{F}_p$ which, by the surjectivity of ev_p, is of dimension $n - k$. Thus $ev_p^{-1}(B) \cong B \times \mathcal{F}_p$ is of Lebesgue measure zero in $\mathcal{F}$. Since the law of X is, by assumption, absolutely continuous with respect to the Lebesgue measure on X, we obtain that $\mathbb{P}(X \in ev_p^{-1}(B)) = 0$ and thus $\mathbb{P}(X(p) \in B) = 0$. This proves that the law of $X(p)$ is absolutely continuous with respect to Lebesgue on $\mathbb{R}^k$ and thus admits a density $\rho_{X(p)} : \mathbb{R}^k \to \mathbb{R}$ and this proves the property *z-KROK* (3).

We can compute this density using the coarea formula for the evcaluation map $ev_p = (ev_p^1, \ldots, ev_p^k) : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}^k$. We obtain for all $p \in M$ and $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$:

$$\rho_{X(p)}(x) = \frac{1}{\left\| ev_p^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge ev_p^k \right\|} \int_{ev_p^{-1}(x)} \rho_X(\varphi) \mathrm{d}\varphi \tag{73}$$

where the norm is the Euclidean norm on $\Lambda^k \mathcal{F}^*$ induced by the scalar product on $\mathcal{F}$. To prove the continuity requirement *z-KROK* (4), we can use the assumption of the behavior at infinity of ρ_X and dominated convergence. Indeed, with the Euclidean structure, we can assume $\mathcal{F} = \mathbb{R}^n$. Let $p \in M$, we can assume that $\mathcal{F}_p = \mathbb{R}^{n-k} \subset \mathbb{R}^n$ is the space spanned by the $n - k$ first coordinates. Then we write $\rho_X(y, x)$ with $y \in \mathbb{R}^{n-k}$ and $x \in \mathbb{R}^k$. Let now $p_j \to p$ and $x_j \to 0$, let $g_j \in O(n)$ be such that $g_j^{-1}(\mathcal{F}_{p_j}) = \mathcal{F}_p = \mathbb{R}^{n-k}$ then we have

$$\rho_{X(p_j)}(x_j) = \frac{1}{\left\| ev_{p_j}^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge ev_{p_j}^k \right\|} \int_{\mathbb{R}^{n-k}} \rho_X(g_j(y), x_j) \mathrm{d}y.$$

On $\mathbb{R}^{n-k}$, the function $y \mapsto \|y\|^{-\alpha}$ is integrable at infinity if and only if $\alpha > n - k$. Thus under our assumption $y \mapsto \rho_X(g_j(y), x_j)$ is dominated by an integrable function uniformly on j and by dominated convergence we get *z-KROK* (4).

We define $\mu(p, x)$ to be the probability measure on $\mathcal{F}$ with support on the affine space $ev_p^{-1}(x)$ that admits the continuous density $\rho_{X,p,x} : ev_p^{-1}(x) \to \mathbb{R}$ that is 0 if $\rho_{X(p)}(x) = 0$ and else is given by

$$\rho_{X,p,x} := \frac{1}{\int_{ev_p^{-1}(x)} \rho_X} \rho_X \Big|_{ev_p^{-1}(x)}. \tag{74}$$

Then $\mu(p, x)$ defines a regular conditional probability for X given $X(p)$. Now let us note that for all $p \in M$, there exists a constant $c = c(p) > 0$ such that $J_p\varphi \leq c\|\varphi\|^k$. Thus the function $\varphi \mapsto J_p\varphi\rho_X(\varphi)$ is at infinity

an $O(\|\varphi\|^{-(\alpha-k)})$ and this is integrable on $ev_p^{-1}(x) \cong \mathbb{R}^{n-k}$ if and only if $\alpha > n$ which is precisely our assumption and this gives us the finiteness condition in *z-KROK* (5). To see the continuity, let $\Psi : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}$ be a bounded continuous function. Let $p_j \to p$ and $x_j \to 0$, we repeat the argument of the previous item to write

$$\langle J_p \cdot \mu(p_j, x_j), \Psi \rangle = \frac{1}{\int_{ev_{p_j}^{-1}(x_j)} \rho_X} \int_{\mathbb{R}^{n-k}} \Psi(g_j(y), x_j) J_p(g_j(y), x_j)\, \rho_X(g_j(y), x_j) \mathrm{d}y$$

for some sequence $g_j \in O(n)$ converging to Id. Since $\rho_X(0) > 0$ we get from Equation (73) that $\rho_{X(p)}(0) > 0$ for every $p \in M$ and we can argue similarly as before: this is dominated by a $O\left(\|\varphi\|^{-(\alpha-k)}\right)$ at infinity which is integrable and we conclude by dominated convergence to obtain *z-KROK* (5). □

In that case we can compute explicitly the zonoid section.

Proposition 10.8. *Let $X \in \mathcal{F} \subset C^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k)$ be* z-KROK *and as in Theorem 10.7. For every $p \in M$ and every $w \in \Lambda^k T_p M$ we have*

$$h_{\zeta_X(p)}(w) = \frac{1}{\left\|ev_p^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge ev_p^k\right\|} \int_{\mathcal{F}_p} \max\left\{0, \left(\mathrm{d}_p\varphi^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^k\right)(w)\right\} \rho_X(\varphi)\mathrm{d}\varphi \tag{75}$$

$$e_X(p)(w) = \frac{1}{\left\|ev_p^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge ev_p^k\right\|} \int_{\mathcal{F}_p} \left(\mathrm{d}_p\varphi^1 \wedge \cdots \wedge \mathrm{d}_p\varphi^k\right)(w) \rho_X(\varphi)\mathrm{d}\varphi \tag{76}$$

where recall that $\mathcal{F}_p = \ker(ev_p) = \{\varphi \in \mathcal{F} \,|\, \varphi(p) = 0\}$, $\rho_X : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}$ is the density of the law of $X \in \mathcal{F}$ and $ev_p = (ev_p^1, \ldots, ev_p^k) : \mathcal{F} \to \mathbb{R}^k$; $\varphi \mapsto \varphi(p)$ is the evaluation map.

Proof. We already did all the work in the proof of Theorem 10.7. In particular we computed the measure $\mu(p, x)$ in (74). Letting $x = 0$ and multiplying by $\rho_{X(p)}(0)$ gives the result. □

Appendix A. Comparison with other typical sets of hypotheses

We compare the *z-KROK* hypotheses (Theorem 4.1) and Theorem 6.1 with other versions of Kac–Rice formula reported in [4, Sec. 11.2] and [6, Sec. 6.1.2]. In the textbooks, a more general type of *weight* α is considered: when $\alpha = \alpha(F, Y, p)$ depends also on an additional random field Y (in [6], while it is called g in [4]). Here, we will only discuss the case of Theorem 34, see also Remark A.2.

Remark A.1. The passage from the simple Kac–Rice formula, with $\alpha = 1$, to the case when α is just a measurable function $\alpha\colon M \to \mathbb{R}$ that does not depend on F, is automatic. This is explained in [74, Remark 2.7].

Remark A.2. The more general frameworks, i.e. when $\alpha = \alpha(Y, F, p)$ depends on an additional random field, can be all covered by assuming that $\alpha\colon \mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k) \times M \overset{\Omega}{\to} \mathbb{R}$ is random. Under this perspective, the hypotheses on the additional field Y (in [4, Theorem 11.2.1] and in [6, Theorem 6.10]) can be viewed (and perhaps simplified) as the conditions under which it is possible to separate the randomness of α and that of X, by conditioning on the former and to make rigorous the following line of identities:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbb{E}\left\{\sum_{p \in F^{-1}(0)} \alpha(F, p)\right\} &= \mathbb{E}_\alpha \mathbb{E}_{(X|\alpha=a)}\left\{\sum_{p \in F^{-1}(0)} a(F, p)\right\} \\
&= \mathbb{E}_\alpha \int_M \mathbb{E}\left\{a(F, p) J_p F \,|\, F(p) = 0, \alpha = a\right\} \rho_{F(p)|\alpha=a}(0) \\
&= \int_M \mathbb{E}\left\{a(F, p) J_p F \,|\, F(p) = 0\right\} \rho_{F(p)}(0).
\end{aligned}$$

and to apply (34) in the inmost expectation, thinking of α as fixed.

A.0.1. *Adler and Taylor's Expectation Metatheorem.* We compare the hypotheses (a), (b), (c), (d), (e), (f) and (g) in [4, Theorem 11.2.1] to the *z-KROK* conditions.

- (a) is equivalent to *z-KROK*-1
- (b) is implied by *z-KROK*-3 and *z-KROK*-4, together. In the opposite direction, *z-KROK*-4 requires continuity also with respect to the spacial variable $p \in M$, which corresponds to $t \in T$ in [4]. Let us call (b+), this slightly stronger version of hypothesis (b).
- (c) We will only consider the case in which $g \equiv 1$, thus (e) is always satisfied, while (c) reduces to the condition that the conditional density $p_t(x|\nabla f(t))$ of $f(t)$ given $\nabla f(t)$ exists, it is bounded, and it is continuous at $x = 0$, uniformly in t. There is no such requirement among the *z-KROK* conditions.

(d) Under finiteness of moments (f), condition (d) is comparable to *z-KROK*-5, though none of the two possible implications hold. Indeed, condition (d) concerns only the pointwise distributions of the jet $j^1_p X = (p, X(p), dX(p)$, while *z-KROK*-5 concerns the distribution of the pairs $(X, X(p))$, but it does not require the existence of the conditional density of $\det dX(p)$ conditioned to $X(p)$. Moreover, it is shown in [4, Lemma 11.2.11] that (a), (b) and (d) together imply *z-KROK*-2.[11]

(e) Thus, (a),(b+),(d),(f) presumably imply *z-KROK*-1-5.

(f) We don't see the role of hypothesis (g) (which can be roughly thought as the requirement that dX is Holder-continuous in probability). Indeed, it does not appear in the version of [6]. This might be due to the different argument used in the proof to prove the inequality "$\geq$". This is the difficult step in all versions of the proof of Kac–Rice formula (the other inequality can be deduced via the coarea formula and Fatou Lemma).

A.0.2. *Azais and Wschebor's version of Rice's formula.* In the case of zero dimensional submanifolds $k = m$ and $M \subset \mathbb{R}^k$ is an open subset, the *z-KROK* hypotheses (Theorem 4.1) are almost identical to the hypotheses of [6, Theorem 6.7] for the level $u = 0$.

(i) is equivalent to *z-KROK*-1.

(ii) is equivalent to the combination of *z-KROK*-3 and *z-KROK*-4.

(iii) is to be compared with the formulation of *z-KROK*-5 that is given in point (4) of Theorem 4.6. In the language of the latter, (iii) says that:

AzaisWscheborbook. There is a regular conditional probability of X given $X(p)$ such that for any continuous function $\beta \in \mathcal{C}(\mathcal{C}^1(M, \mathbb{R}^k); \mathbb{R})$ and any converging sequence $(p_n, x_n) \to (p_0, x_0)$ in a neighborhood of $M \times \{0\}$ in $M \times \mathbb{R}^k$, we have that

$$\mathbb{E}\{\beta(X) \,|\, X(p_n) = x_n\} \to \mathbb{E}\{\beta(X) \,|\, X(p_0) = x_0\}\,. \tag{77}$$

The differences between the condition above and ours are three:

(a) In Theorem 4.6.(4) the property should be valid for all sequences $\beta_n \to \beta_0$. From point (2) of Theorem 4.6 it is clear that this difference is irrelevant.

(b) For Condition (4) of Theorem 4.6 to be true it is sufficient to verify (77) when $x_0 = 0$.

(c) In Theorem 4.6 (4) a bound is assumed: $\beta(f) \leq C J_{p_n} f$, while in (iii) there is no restriction on the class of functions β for which (77) should hold. Because of this, condition (iii) seems ill posed in that the expression (77) may take infinite values even for Gaussian fields, for instance with $\beta(f) = \exp(|f(p)|^3)$, where $p \in M$ is a fixed point.

(iv) is equivalent to *z-KROK*.

In conclusion, we can say that *z-KROK* (5) is a weaker assumption than (iii), while all other hypotheses are equivalent, thus Theorem 6.1 implies [6, Theorem 6.7].

Appendix B. Source code for symbols

The symbol $\Subset$ used in this article was made out of two symbols $\subset$ combined into the command `\randin` with the following code

```
%\newcommand*\,\randin\,{
\mathchoice {\raisebox{-.35ex}{$\displaystyle{^\subset}$}\mkern-11.5mu\raisebox{+.45ex}
{$\displaystyle{_\subset}$}}
{\mkern+1mu\raisebox{-.27ex}{$\textstyle{^\subset}$}\mkern-11.7mu\raisebox{+.45ex}
{$\textstyle{_\subset}$}{\raisebox{.35ex}{$\scriptstyle\subset$}
\mkern-14mu\raisebox{-.15ex}{$\scriptstyle\subset$}}{\raisebox{.3ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle\subset$}
\mkern-13.5mu\raisebox{-.10ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle\subset$}} }
```

The symbol $\multimap$ is the command `\randto` defined with the following code.

```
\newcommand{\maschera}{\textcolor{white}{\scalebox{0.3}{$\blacktriangle$}}}
\newcommand*\FlatOmega{
\mathchoice{
\displaystyle{\Omega}\mkern-14mu\raisebox{+.166ex}{$\displaystyle{\maschera}$}
\mkern+7mu\raisebox{+.166ex}{$\displaystyle{\maschera}$}}{
\hbox{$\textstyle{\Omega}$}\mkern-14mu\raisebox{+.166ex}{\hbox{$\textstyle{\maschera}$}}
\mkern+7mu\raisebox{+.166ex}{\hbox{$\textstyle{\maschera}$}}}{
\scriptstyle{\Omega}\mkern-14mu\raisebox{+.13ex}{$\scriptstyle{\maschera}$}
\mkern+5mu\raisebox{+.13ex}{$\scriptstyle{\maschera}$}}{
\scriptscriptstyle{\Omega}\mkern-14mu\raisebox{+.13ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle{\maschera}$}
\mkern+5mu\raisebox{+.13ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle{\maschera}$}}}
\newcommand{\scaledFlatOmega}{{\scalebox{0.8}{$_{\FlatOmega}$}}}
%\newcommand*\randto{
\mathchoice{
\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\displaystyle{-}$}\mkern-4.4mu\raisebox{.729ex}
{$\displaystyle{\scaledFlatOmega}$}
\mkern-5.2mu\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\displaystyle\to$}}{
\raisebox{-.101ex}{\hbox{$\textstyle{-}$}}\mkern-4.4mu\raisebox{.729ex}
{\hbox{$\textstyle{\scaledFlatOmega}$}}
\mkern-5.2mu\raisebox{-.101ex}{\hbox{$\textstyle\to$}}}{
```

[11] In the in the current version of the book [4], the statement of Lemma 11.2.11 includes the hypothesis (g) from Theorem 11.2.1. However, in the document *Correction and Commentary* (downloadable on the book's first author's website) this hypothesis is said to be removable.

```
\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\scriptstyle{-}$}\mkern-4.4mu\raisebox{.729ex}{$\scriptstyle{\scaledFlatOmega}$}
\mkern-5.2mu\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\scriptstyle\to$}}{
\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle{-}$}\mkern-4.4mu\raisebox{.729ex}
{$\scriptscriptstyle{\scaledFlatOmega}$}
\mkern-5.2mu\raisebox{-.101ex}{$\scriptscriptstyle\to$}}}
```

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